



IMMIGRATION PROFESSIONAL PLANNER — 2027 —

*Organize your practice. Strengthen your
knowledge. Grow with intention.*



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Immigration Professional Planner 2027

Organize your practice. Strengthen your knowledge. Grow with intention.

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This planner is intended for educational, organizational, and professional development purposes. It is not legal advice. See the full professional notice on its own page.



This planner belongs to

CONTACT INFORMATION

NAME

ORGANIZATION

POSITION

EMAIL

PHONE

YEAR

IF FOUND, PLEASE CONTACT:

The professional I choose to be

Write these answers before you fill in your calendar. Come back to them when the year gets complicated.

I want to be a professional who...

My clients can expect from me...

My team can expect from me...

I never want my professional growth to make me forget...



How to use this planner

Your practice is not built only on the cases you handle. It is built on what you learn, what you document, the relationships you cultivate, and the mistakes you decide not to repeat.

This planner is designed as a second brain for anyone who works in immigration: one place for what you have to do, what you cannot forget, your cases and consultations, your deadlines, what you are learning, your team, and your professional relationships.

There is no single right way to use it. You can fill in every page or keep only the tools that serve you. It is used by attorneys, accredited representatives, paralegals, intake staff, office managers, and document preparers, so not everything applies to everyone.

The rhythm of the planner. Each day holds your priorities, your schedule, and a professional capsule. Each week starts with a plan, a case review, and a micro-lesson, and ends with a Friday practice review. Each month opens with a monthly reset, a plan, and a challenge. Each quarter includes a review of your practice.

The tools. After the calendar you will find My cases, My practice, My knowledge, Immigration vocabulary, My growth, My social capital, and the resource library. Many pages are templates you can print again.



THIS SYMBOL MARKS WHAT BELONGS ONLY TO AN ATTORNEY OR AUTHORIZED REPRESENTATIVE

Giving legal advice, setting case strategy, assessing eligibility, and representing someone before an agency or court belong only to those authorized to do so. The rest of the team gathers information, organizes, and follows up. No tool in this planner authorizes anyone to practice law without a license.

Educational tools do not replace legal research. The pages on sources, the immigration system, vocabulary, and artificial intelligence teach method, not rules. This planner contains no calculated deadlines and no rules that apply to a specific case.

Always verify current sources. Immigration law changes constantly: statutes, regulations, forms, fees, policies, and precedent. Before you rely on any authority, open the original source, confirm it is still current, and write down the date you verified it.

Three habits that make it work:

- ☒ Monday: fill in This week before you open your email.
- ☒ Friday: do your weekly review, even if you only have ten minutes.
- ☒ End of month: close out the month before you plan the next one.



Professional notice

This planner is intended for **educational, organizational, and professional development purposes**.

It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship with the author.

It does not replace independent legal research. Immigration statutes, regulations, forms, policies, and precedent may change at any time.

Anyone using this planner must **verify that every legal authority is current** before relying on it, using the corresponding official source.

Content related to legal practice must be used **only within the professional and legal limits that apply** to each user, according to their role, license or accreditation, and jurisdiction. Rules on the unauthorized practice of law (UPL) vary by state and by professional role.

Federal holidays and any reference to government office closures are included for guidance only and must be confirmed with the official source.

Supplementary digital resources will be announced at lcdajessicalperezsalazar.com as they become available.

Always verify current information.

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Find it fast

Tool pages are grouped by system. Also use your personal index at the end of the planner to note where you keep what you look up most.

 Schedule, weeks, and months

 Consultations and intake

 Research and the BIA

 Courses and mentoring

 Vocabulary and legal English

 Reviews and growth

 Cases and files

 Hearings and ethics

 Artificial intelligence

 Networking and referrals

 Procedures and quality control

 Resources and library

Icon system

Each icon marks a type of content, so you can spot an ethics capsule, a research task, or something to remember at a glance. Gold marks what to look at first.

 Ethics and law

 Reflection

 Lessons learned

 Learning

 Write and document

 Reminder

 Idea

 Professional capital

 Training

 Knowledge

 System and process

 Action

 Artificial intelligence

 Research

 Attention

 Attorney or authorized representative only

The six systems

The whole planner revolves around six systems. Professional ethics is not one more system: it runs through all six.





MY TIME

System 1

Schedule, calendar, priorities, deadlines, meetings, consultations, and follow-up.



MY CASES

System 2

Intake, consultations, case strategy, case timelines, hearings, interviews, quality control, and case closing.



MY PRACTICE

System 3

Processes, team, supervision, quality, errors, client experience, and systems.



MY KNOWLEDGE

System 4

Case law, research, courses, reading, library, and AI tools.



MY GROWTH

System 5

Goals, mentoring, reflection, lessons learned, and evaluation.



MY SOCIAL CAPITAL

System 6

Contacts, professional network, organizations, referrals, and relationship follow-up.



Professional ethics is present in every system: in how you use your time, how you handle your cases, how you supervise, which sources you rely on, how you grow, and how you relate to others.

My development path

Growing professionally does not mean consuming more information. It means moving through this cycle again and again.



In what matters most to me this year, which stage am I in?

What do I need to move to the next one?

LEARNING

My learning system

Record what you want to turn into a skill. Check off each step as you complete it.

KNOWLEDGE OR SKILL	LEARNED	VERIFIED	SAVED	APPLIED	REVIEWED	CAN TEACH
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

My practice

Name

Organization

Role

Jurisdiction / license or accreditation, if applicable

Years working in immigration

Practice areas

Languages

My team

Approximate number of active cases

My professional identity

Why do I work in immigration?

What kind of professional do I want to be?

What values do I want to define my practice?

What do I want my clients and colleagues to remember about working with me?

MY 2027

My vision for this year



Describe how you want your practice, your learning, and your professional life to look on December 31, 2027.

Three words for my year

How I will know it was a good year

My goals

☒ MY 5 PROFESSIONAL GOALS

1

2

3

4

5

 MY 3 EDUCATIONAL GOALS

1

2

3

 MY 3 FINANCIAL OR PRACTICE GOALS

1

2

3

THE FIRST STEP TOWARD EACH GOAL

Relationships and well-being

 MY PROFESSIONAL NETWORKING GOALS

 MY PROFESSIONAL WELL-BEING GOALS

What boundaries will I protect this year?

Learn, stop, start

 WHAT I WANT TO LEARN

 WHAT I WANT TO STOP DOING

 WHAT I WANT TO START DOING



Annual calendar

January	February	March	April	May	June
1 F	1 M	1 M	1 T	1 S	1 T
2 S	2 T	2 T	2 F	2 S	2 W
3 S	3 W	3 W	3 S	3 M	3 T
4 M	4 T	4 T	4 S	4 T	4 F
5 T	5 F	5 F	5 M	5 W	5 S
6 W	6 S	6 S	6 T	6 T	6 S
7 T	7 S	7 S	7 W	7 F	7 M
8 F	8 M	8 M	8 T	8 S	8 T
9 S	9 T	9 T	9 F	9 S	9 W
10 S	10 W	10 W	10 S	10 M	10 T
11 M	11 T	11 T	11 S	11 T	11 F
12 T	12 F	12 F	12 M	12 W	12 S
13 W	13 S	13 S	13 T	13 T	13 S
14 T	14 S	14 S	14 W	14 F	14 M
15 F	15 M	15 M	15 T	15 S	15 T
16 S	16 T	16 T	16 F	16 S	16 W
17 S	17 W	17 W	17 S	17 M	17 T
18 M	18 T	18 T	18 S	18 T	18 F
19 T	19 F	19 F	19 M	19 W	19 S
20 W	20 S	20 S	20 T	20 T	20 S
21 T	21 S	21 S	21 W	21 F	21 M
22 F	22 M	22 M	22 T	22 S	22 T
23 S	23 T	23 T	23 F	23 S	23 W
24 S	24 W	24 W	24 S	24 M	24 T
25 M	25 T	25 T	25 S	25 T	25 F
26 T	26 F	26 F	26 M	26 W	26 S
27 W	27 S	27 S	27 T	27 T	27 S
28 T	28 S	28 S	28 W	28 F	28 M
29 F		29 M	29 T	29 S	29 T
30 S		30 T	30 F	30 S	30 W
31 S		31 W		31 M	

H Hearing · I Interview · D Deadline · C CLE · F Conference · V Vacation · R Renewal · W Workshop · P Project · L Launch · ★ Personal · federal holiday (verify closures)

2027 AT A GLANCE

Annual calendar

July	August	September	October	November	December
1 T	1 S	1 W	1 F	1 M	1 W
2 F	2 M	2 T	2 S	2 T	2 T
3 S	3 T	3 F	3 S	3 W	3 F
4 S	4 W	4 S	4 M	4 T	4 S
5 M	5 T	5 S	5 T	5 F	5 S
6 T	6 F	6 M	6 W	6 S	6 M
7 W	7 S	7 T	7 T	7 S	7 T
8 T	8 S	8 W	8 F	8 M	8 W
9 F	9 M	9 T	9 S	9 T	9 T
10 S	10 T	10 F	10 S	10 W	10 F
11 S	11 W	11 S	11 M	11 T	11 S
12 M	12 T	12 S	12 T	12 F	12 S
13 T	13 F	13 M	13 W	13 S	13 M
14 W	14 S	14 T	14 T	14 S	14 T
15 T	15 S	15 W	15 F	15 M	15 W
16 F	16 M	16 T	16 S	16 T	16 T
17 S	17 T	17 F	17 S	17 W	17 F
18 S	18 W	18 S	18 M	18 T	18 S
19 M	19 T	19 S	19 T	19 F	19 S
20 T	20 F	20 M	20 W	20 S	20 M
21 W	21 S	21 T	21 T	21 S	21 T
22 T	22 S	22 W	22 F	22 M	22 W
23 F	23 M	23 T	23 S	23 T	23 T
24 S	24 T	24 F	24 S	24 W	24 F
25 S	25 W	25 S	25 M	25 T	25 S
26 M	26 T	26 S	26 T	26 F	26 S
27 T	27 F	27 M	27 W	27 S	27 M
28 W	28 S	28 T	28 T	28 S	28 T
29 T	29 S	29 W	29 F	29 M	29 W
30 F	30 M	30 T	30 S	30 T	30 T
31 S	31 T		31 S		31 F

H Hearing · I Interview · D Deadline · C CLE · F Conference · V Vacation · R Renewal · W Workshop · P Project · L Launch · ★ Personal · federal holiday (verify closures)

Future log

January 2027

February 2027

March 2027

April 2027

May 2027

June 2027

Future log

July 2027

August 2027

September 2027

October 2027

November 2027

December 2027

My ideal week

	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY
7 AM				
8				
9				
10				
11				
12 PM				
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7 PM				

	FRIDAY	SATURDAY	SUNDAY
7 AM			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12 PM			
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7 PM			

BLOCKS: ASSIGN A COLOR OR A LETTER TO EACH ONE

- ☐ Deep work
 ☐ Client meetings
 ☐ Hearings
- ☐ Calls
 ☐ Research
 ☐ Team
- ☐ Administration
 ☐ Learning
 ☐ Personal

Where does the work that no one else can do for you go?

REFERENCE

2027 and 2028 calendars

2027

January							February							March							April							May							June						
M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
28	29	30	31	1	2	3	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	29	30	31	1	2	3	4	26	27	28	29	30	1	2	31	1	2	3	4	5	6
4	5	6	7	8	9	10	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
11	12	13	14	15	16	17	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
18	19	20	21	22	23	24	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	21	22	23	24	25	26	27
25	26	27	28	29	30	31								29	30	31	1	2	3	4	26	27	28	29	30	1	2	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	28	29	30	1	2	3	4
																												31	1	2	3	4	5	6							

July							August							September							October							November							December						
M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
28	29	30	1	2	3	4	26	27	28	29	30	31	1	30	31	1	2	3	4	5	27	28	29	30	1	2	3	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	29	30	1	2	3	4	5
5	6	7	8	9	10	11	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
12	13	14	15	16	17	18	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	13	14	15	16	17	18	19
19	20	21	22	23	24	25	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	20	21	22	23	24	25	26
26	27	28	29	30	31	1	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	27	28	29	30	1	2	3	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	29	30	1	2	3	4	5	27	28	29	30	31	1	2
							30	31	1	2	3	4	5																												

2028

January							February							March							April							May							June						
M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
27	28	29	30	31	1	2	31	1	2	3	4	5	6	28	29	1	2	3	4	5	27	28	29	30	31	1	2	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	29	30	31	1	2	3	4
3	4	5	6	7	8	9	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
10	11	12	13	14	15	16	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
17	18	19	20	21	22	23	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	19	20	21	22	23	24	25
24	25	26	27	28	29	30	28	29	1	2	3	4	5	27	28	29	30	31	1	2	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	29	30	31	1	2	3	4	26	27	28	29	30	1	2
31	1	2	3	4	5	6																																			

July							August							September							October							November							December						
M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
26	27	28	29	30	1	2	31	1	2	3	4	5	6	28	29	30	31	1	2	3	25	26	27	28	29	30	1	30	31	1	2	3	4	5	27	28	29	30	1	2	3
3	4	5	6	7	8	9	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
10	11	12	13	14	15	16	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	11	12	13	14	15	16	17
17	18	19	20	21	22	23	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	18	19	20	21	22	23	24
24	25	26	27	28	29	30	28	29	30	31	1	2	3	25	26	27	28	29	30	1	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	27	28	29	30	1	2	3	25	26	27	28	29	30	31
31	1	2	3	4	5	6															30	31	1	2	3	4	5														

📅 2027 OBSERVED FEDERAL HOLIDAYS

January 1	New Year's Day	September 6	Labor Day
January 18	Birthday of Martin Luther King, Jr.	October 11	Columbus Day
February 15	Washington's Birthday	November 11	Veterans Day
May 31	Memorial Day	November 25	Thanksgiving Day
June 18	Juneteenth National Independence Day (observed)	December 24	Christmas Day (observed)
July 5	Independence Day (observed)	December 31	New Year's Day 2028 (observed)

Confirm these dates with the Office of Personnel Management (OPM) and verify USCIS and EOIR closures, which may vary by office or court.

MY TIME



How your year works

This section covers 53 weeks, from Monday, December 28, 2026 to Sunday, January 2, 2028. Each part has its moment:

Monthly reset



Before planning a new month, review the last one: what worked, what didn't, who you met and what you don't want to repeat.

Monthly plan and calendar



Three priorities, the cases that need attention and the month's professional challenge.

This week



On Monday: priorities, hearings, intakes, consultations, deadlines, case review and the micro-lesson of the week.

The days



Two days per page: priorities, an 8 AM to 6 PM schedule, tasks, follow-up, deadlines and a professional capsule.

Friday practice review



Ten minutes every Friday to close the week and avoid carrying tasks forward.

Quarterly reviews



At the close of March, June, September and December: practice review, office audit and a plan for the next quarter.



Observed federal holidays are marked in gold. Confirm them and verify USCIS and EOIR closures.

My 2027 quarters

Quarter 1  MY FOCUS  LEARNING	JANUARY • FEBRUARY • MARCH  MAIN PROJECT  RELATIONSHIP I WANT TO CULTIVATE
Quarter 2  MY FOCUS  LEARNING	APRIL • MAY • JUNE  MAIN PROJECT  RELATIONSHIP I WANT TO CULTIVATE
Quarter 3  MY FOCUS  LEARNING	JULY • AUGUST • SEPTEMBER  MAIN PROJECT  RELATIONSHIP I WANT TO CULTIVATE
Quarter 4  MY FOCUS  LEARNING	OCTOBER • NOVEMBER • DECEMBER  MAIN PROJECT  RELATIONSHIP I WANT TO CULTIVATE

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



JANUARY

2027



*Begin the year with intention,
structure, and purpose.*

Starting point

What am I bringing from 2026 that I want to keep?

Which cases or matters need attention from day one?

What do I want to learn this quarter?

Which professional relationship do I want to cultivate?

What am I leaving behind?

Which process do I want to improve first?

What should I delegate starting in January?

Which 2026 mistake do I not want to repeat?



PEOPLE I WANT TO CONNECT WITH IN JANUARY

January 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

January



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Organize your calendar

- ☐ Bring case dates, hearings and deadlines into a single calendar.
- ☐ Decide who enters each date and who verifies it.
- ☐ Set staggered reminders for this quarter's deadlines.

MON	TUE	WED
28	29	30
4	5	6
11	12	13
18 🕒 Birthday of Martin Luther King, Jr. Verify closures	19	20
25	26	27

🕒 MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU

31

7

14

21

28

🕒 KEY DEADLINES

📖 LEARNING

FRI

1
🗓️ New Year's Day
Verify closures

8

15

22

29

🏛️ HEARINGS

📄 PERSONAL

SAT

2

9

16

23

30

✍️ INTAKES

📝 NOTES

SUN

3

10

17

24

31

This week

Dec 28, 2026 – Jan 3, 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 DEADLINES

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

 TEAM

 ADMINISTRATIVE

 LEARNING

 PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

 I MUST DELEGATE

 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • TIME

Three non-negotiable blocks

Before the year fills up, reserve three fixed blocks on your calendar each week: one for deep work without interruptions, one to review deadlines and active files, and one to answer pending messages. Name them and treat them like a client appointment. If someone asks for that time, offer another slot; don't give it up out of habit.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

‡ MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

⚖️ ETHICS

When a non-attorney tells a client what's best for them, they've crossed the line from informing to advising.

Saturday *January 2*

ORGANIZATION

Every file should tell its own story: anyone opening it for the first time should know where the case stands.

Sunday *January 3*

RESEARCH

Before citing a decision, confirm it's still good law and that nothing later has changed it.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jan 4 – Jan 10, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CALENDAR

The double check

Every date goes on the calendar the same day the notice arrives. Two people calculate it separately, without seeing each other's work. If they don't match, the person responsible for the case decides, and you record who verified it.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **COMMUNICATION**

A clear message saves three phone calls. Before sending it, read it as a frightened client would.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **SUPERVISION**

Supervising isn't reviewing everything; it's knowing what to review and when.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



INTAKE

Intake gathers facts; legal evaluation belongs to someone authorized to give it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CLIENTS

No one on the team promises results. Options, risks and steps are explained with the same honesty in every conversation.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

AI



Before pasting a document into an AI tool, remove names, case numbers and anything that identifies your client.

Saturday *January 9*

NETWORKING

A professional relationship is built before you need it, not the day you need a favor.

Sunday *January 10*

EDUCATION

Before signing up for a course, define the specific problem in your practice you want it to solve.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

- ☐ Met my deadlines
- ☐ Answered key communications
- ☐ Documented
- ☐ Reviewed open items
- ☐
- Supervised
- ☐ Learned
- ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jan 11 – Jan 17, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗨 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • INTAKE

The five intake questions

Every intake must answer five things: who the person is, what immigration documents they have, whether they have an open case in court or with USCIS, whether any date is coming up and how they prefer to be contacted. Intake staff gather and record; they don't evaluate eligibility or suggest options. If an answer is missing, the intake isn't complete.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **PROFESSIONAL GROWTH**
Every closed case leaves a lesson. Write it down before the next emergency erases it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **DOCUMENTATION**
Every file note answers five things: who, when, what was said, what was decided and what's next.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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4

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DELEGATION

Delegate the outcome, not just the task: what's due, by when and what done well looks like.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CASE LAW

What the court decided is what it needed to decide. Treat the rest with caution before citing it as a rule.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

A team can't meet expectations you never explained clearly.

Saturday *January 16*

ERROR PREVENTION

Check names, dates of birth and A-numbers against the source document, not against another copy.

Sunday *January 17*

ETHICS

Unsure if your answer is legal advice? That doubt is your signal to refer it to someone who can give it.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jan 18 – Jan 24, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

🗂 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • FILE NOTES

The three-point note

Every contact with your client or an agency gets a note the same day. Three minimum points: what happened, what was agreed and the next step with its owner. Write as if someone else on the team had to pick up the case tomorrow without being able to call you. If the note doesn't allow that, it isn't finished.

MondayJanuary18

FEDERAL HOLIDAY: BIRTHDAY OF MARTIN LUTHER KING, JR. • VERIFY CLOSURES

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

ORGANIZATION

Record every deadline in two places and assign one person to confirm it.

TuesdayJanuary19

DAY 19 • 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

RESEARCH

A summary or commentary points the way; the primary source governs.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

COMMUNICATION

🔗 If the client just nods at your explanation, ask them to tell it back in their own words. Then you'll know.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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3

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

☑ SUPERVISION

Vague instructions produce vague work. Before delegating, define the expected result and the due date.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



INTAKE

If a prospective client asks “Do I qualify?”, the intake answer is to explain who can evaluate that and when.

Saturday *January 23*

CLIENTS

An informed client asks better questions and makes better decisions about their own case.

Sunday *January 24*

AI

If AI gives you a citation, open it and read it. A source you can't find doesn't exist for purposes of your brief.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jan 25 – Jan 31, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

⚖️ HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • UNAUTHORIZED PRACTICE

The phrase that protects the team

Train all your non-attorney staff to use the same phrase when someone asks for an opinion: “Only someone authorized to represent you can answer that question; I'll take note and pass it along today.”

Explaining options, evaluating eligibility or recommending a filing is legal advice. Gathering information, scheduling and delivering documents is not. Practice the phrase out loud.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

NETWORKING

After meeting someone at an event, write to them that same week. Follow-up turns a greeting into a contact.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

EDUCATION

One course finished and applied beats five started and forgotten.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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4

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Asking for help in time is a professional decision; asking too late often becomes an emergency.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DOCUMENTATION

Write the note the same day. Memory reconstructs; records preserve.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DELEGATION

A clear instruction includes its purpose. Those who understand the why make better calls along the way.

Saturday *January 30*

CASE LAW

A precedent applies because the relevant facts are similar, not because some words match.

Sunday *January 31*

LEADERSHIP

Give feedback close to the moment. Waiting for the annual review turns a correction into a surprise.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



FEBRUARY

— 2027 —



*Move forward with focus,
consistency, and clarity.*



January reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

February 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

February



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Audit your files

- ☐ Pick ten active files at random.
- ☐ Review notes, documents, deadlines and the last communication.
- ☐ Note what is missing and fix the process that caused it.

MON	TUE	WED
1	2	3
8	9	10
15 📅 Washington's Birthday Verify closures	16	17
22	23	24

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
4	5	6	7
11	12	13	14
18	19	20	21
25	26	27	28

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🏛️ HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
🎓 LEARNING	📖 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

Feb 1 – Feb 7, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

🗂️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • PRIMARY SOURCES

Always go to the source

A social media summary, a webinar or a colleague's message tells you where to look, not what the rule says. Before applying any change, open the current official source: the statute, the regulation, the policy manual or the agency's page. Note in the file which source you checked and on what date. If you can't cite it, you can't use it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

ⓘ

ERROR PREVENTION

Before using a form, confirm you have the current edition. What worked before may not work today.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

⚖️

ETHICS

Confidentiality doesn't end when you close the file or when the client stops being your client.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📁 ORGANIZATION

An important email that isn't in the file is, for your office, an email that doesn't exist.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

🔍 RESEARCH

Read the whole decision, not just the paragraph someone quoted. Context changes the scope.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📌 COMMUNICATION

Communicating in the client's language isn't a courtesy; it's what makes their decisions truly informed.

Saturday February 6

SUPERVISION

*Does your team feel free to say "I didn't understand"?
If not, you're supervising blind.*

Sunday February 7

INTAKE

*Write down the client's exact words when they
describe an important fact. Summarizing too soon can
change the meaning.*

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Feb 8 – Feb 14, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

🔗 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CONFIDENTIALITY

Screens, voices and hallways

Confidentiality breaks down more from carelessness than bad intent. This week, check three things: screens visible from reception, client calls in open areas and files left on desks at the end of the day. Fix one each day. Remind the team that confirming whether someone is a client is already protected information, even if a relative is asking.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **CLIENTS**
Behind every file is a family waiting. Remember that when the day turns routine.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **AI**
AI can write a first draft. The signature at the bottom is still yours.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

NETWORKING

Before referring a client, verify the credentials and practice area of whoever will receive them. Your name goes with that referral.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

EDUCATION

After each training, write down three changes you'll put in place this week.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

What did you learn this week that would change how you handled a case a year ago?

Saturday February 13

DOCUMENTATION

Keep an exact copy of what you filed, not of the draft you thought was final.

Sunday February 14

DELEGATION

Set review checkpoints before delegating, not after the problem shows up.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Feb 15 – Feb 21, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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🗓 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • BIA

How to read a decision

Read a Board decision in this order: first the question it resolved, then what it decided, then the reasoning and, finally, the facts that made it possible. Highlight in a different color what the Board held and what is commentary. Before citing it, verify in the official source that it's still good law and hasn't been modified or overruled.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

CASE LAW

Before relying on a decision, check whether later authority overruled, limited or distinguished it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

LEADERSHIP

Protecting your time to think isn't a luxury. It's part of your responsibility as a leader.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

Open the attachment before attaching it. A file with the right name can have the wrong content.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

ETHICS



Before taking a case, ask yourself honestly whether you have the competence, time and resources to handle it well.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

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6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

ORGANIZATION

Block time on your calendar for deep work before emergencies claim it.

Saturday February 20

RESEARCH

Note the date you checked each source. In immigration, what's correct today may change soon.

Sunday February 21

COMMUNICATION

Does your office have a clear rule for after-hours messages, or does everyone decide based on fatigue?

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

- ☐ Met my deadlines
- ☐ Answered key communications
- ☐ Documented
- ☐ Reviewed open items
- ☐
- Supervised
- ☐ Learned
- ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Feb 22 – Feb 28, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

🗂️ HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

🧩 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

🧩 I MUST DELEGATE

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • SUPERVISION

Review before signing

No document goes out with your signature unless you've reviewed all of it. Have every draft come with a short cover sheet: what was prepared, which sources were used, what questions remain and what's missing. Then you review methodically, not in a rush. Professional responsibility can't be delegated; the work can, if your supervision is real and documented.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

☒ **SUPERVISION**

Correct in private, recognize in public, and document both when they affect performance.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

☒ **INTAKE**

Always ask about dates, places and documents. Details that seem minor often change the analysis.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

CLIENTS

Does the client know the next step in their case and who will take it? If not, you're not done.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

AI

Do you know what the tool does with what you type? Read its terms of use before trusting it with case information.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



NETWORKING

What can you offer in this conversation? Start there, not with what you hope to get.

Saturday February 27

EDUCATION

Seek mentoring in the area you want to master.
Someone else's experience can save you years of trial and error.

Sunday February 28

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Teaching others what you know is the most honest test of whether you truly understand it.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



MARCH

— 2027 —



Turn knowledge into action.



February reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

March 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

March



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Create or improve a procedure

- ☐ Choose the task you repeat most or the one that causes the most errors.
- ☐ Write it out step by step, with an owner and a quality control check.
- ☐ Test it with someone on your team and adjust it.

MON	TUE	WED
1	2	3
8	9	10
15	16	17
22	23	24
29	30	31

MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
4	5	6	7
11	12	13	14
18	19	20	21
25	26	27	28
1	2	3	4

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🏛️ HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
📖 LEARNING	📅 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

Mar 1 – Mar 7, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

⚖️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • WHATSAPP

WhatsApp with clear rules

If your office uses WhatsApp, set four rules in writing: which office number is used, during what hours you respond, which topics aren't handled that way and how each relevant conversation gets into the file. Never send legal analysis or sensitive documents through personal messaging. A message that isn't in the file, for practical purposes, doesn't exist.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

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4

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6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **DOCUMENTATION**
Could someone else on your team pick up this case tomorrow using only what's in the file?

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **DELEGATION**
Who on your team can decide this without asking you? If you don't know, you need an authority matrix.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CASE LAW

Distinguish precedent from non-precedent decisions. Both can guide you, but they don't bind equally.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

Are your instructions in writing? What's only said aloud gets interpreted many ways.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

A checklist doesn't insult your experience; it protects your focus on your most interrupted days.

Saturday *March 6*

ETHICS

A conflict of interest caught late costs far more than a check done on time.

Sunday *March 7*

ORGANIZATION

A checklist doesn't insult your experience; it protects your client from your tired days.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I need to correct

Something I learned

Something I won't carry into next week

Priority for next week

This week

Mar 8 – Mar 14, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • VERIFICATION

Verify the data, not your memory

The most common error on a form isn't the law; it's the data: an entry date, a receipt number, a name spelled differently. Before sending, compare each item against the original document, not against what you remember or the previous draft. Mark each verified field. Your memory is good; the document is better.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **RESEARCH**

Write out the legal question before you search. A precise question saves hours of reading.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **COMMUNICATION**

Deliver bad news early, in person when possible, with the next step already thought through.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



SUPERVISION

Micromanaging wears out the team; checking out exposes clients. Good supervision lives in between.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



INTAKE

No one in the waiting room should hear another client's full name, A-number or story.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CLIENTS

Explain what your engagement agreement covers and what it doesn't. Fee surprises damage trust.

Saturday *March 13*

AI

An AI translation is a starting point. Have someone fluent in both languages review it before delivering it.

Sunday *March 14*

NETWORKING

Share a useful resource with a colleague unprompted. Professional generosity is remembered.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Mar 15 – Mar 21, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗓 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • USCIS

The self-explanatory package

Build every application so the reviewer understands the case without hunting for anything. Use a cover letter with an index, separate the evidence into sections that follow the order of what you're requesting and label each document. Confirm requirements, form editions and filing address on the current official USCIS website the same day you send it.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 EDUCATION

Share what you learned with your team. Teaching deepens your understanding.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Knowing your limits doesn't make you less professional; it makes you trustworthy.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📌 DOCUMENTATION

An important call without a note leaves the file with no answer when someone asks what was agreed.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📌 DELEGATION

You delegate execution; professional responsibility still carries your name.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CASE LAW

A dissent may foreshadow change, but today it isn't the rule applied to your client.

Saturday *March 20*

LEADERSHIP

Recognize good work in public and correct what needs improvement in private.

Sunday *March 21*

ERROR PREVENTION

Double review works best when the second person didn't help prepare the document.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I need to correct

Something I learned

Something I won't carry into next week

Priority for next week

This week

Mar 22 – Mar 28, 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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3

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 DEADLINES

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 FOLLOW-UP

 TEAM

 ADMINISTRATIVE

 LEARNING

 PERSONAL

 I MUST FINISH

 I MUST DELEGATE

 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • DELEGATION

Delegate with a defined result

When delegating, don't just say "take care of this." Define three things: the expected result, the deadline and which decision must come back to you. Ask the person to restate the task in their own words before starting. If they can't, the instruction wasn't clear. Delegating well saves more time than doing everything yourself.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

⚖️ **ETHICS**
Explaining fees in writing and in the client's language is part of the service, not a formality.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

📁 **ORGANIZATION**
Name digital files using one agreed format. Tomorrow's search depends on today's discipline.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



RESEARCH

Look for the authority against your position, too. Better you find it than hear it from the other side.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



COMMUNICATION

A relevant call that wasn't documented is, for the file, a conversation that never happened.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

☒ **SUPERVISION**
Review a new person's work more closely, and loosen up as they show sound judgment.

Saturday *March 27*

INTAKE
A good intake form guides the conversation, but it shouldn't keep you from hearing the unexpected.

Sunday *March 28*

CLIENTS
When a client asks the front desk for a legal opinion, the answer is kind and firm: the attorney will explain that.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

Quarter in review

 CLIENTS

- Communication
- Expectations
- Complaints
- Follow-up

 CASES

- Backlog
- Deadlines
- Errors
- Outcomes

 TEAM

- Workload
- Supervision
- Training
- Feedback

 PROCESSES

- What works
- What's missing
- What to automate
- What to eliminate

 KNOWLEDGE

What I learned

What I need to learn

Courses

Case law

 SOCIAL CAPITAL

New people

Relationships

Referrals

Collaborations

 ME

What am I doing better?

What do I keep avoiding?

Where do I need help?

What must I not do
again?

In one sentence, this quarter was...

Office audit

AREA	NEEDS WORK	WORKS	STRONG	ACTION NEEDED
Calendar	☐	☐	☐	
Files	☐	☐	☐	
Case notes	☐	☐	☐	
Client communication	☐	☐	☐	
Deadlines	☐	☐	☐	
Billing	☐	☐	☐	
Supervision	☐	☐	☐	
Technology	☐	☐	☐	
Security	☐	☐	☐	
AI	☐	☐	☐	
Training	☐	☐	☐	
Closed cases	☐	☐	☐	

QUARTER PLAN

Second quarter 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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3

 PROCESS I WILL IMPROVE

 WHAT I WILL LEARN

 RELATIONSHIP I WILL CULTIVATE

 PROJECT

 WHAT I WILL STOP DOING

 WHAT I WILL DELEGATE

 DATE OF MY NEXT REVIEW

 WHO I WILL REVIEW IT WITH

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



APRIL

2027



*Review, adjust, and
keep moving forward.*



March reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

April 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

April



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Review your agreements and engagement process

- ☐ Read your services agreement as if you were the client.
- ☐ Confirm the scope, what is not included and third-party costs are clear.
- ☐ Review how the agreement is explained before signing.

MON

TUE

WED

29

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28

MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
1	2	3	4
8	9	10	11
15	16	17	18
22	23	24	25
29	30	1	2

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🏛️ HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
🎓 LEARNING	📅 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

Mar 29 – Apr 4, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗓 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • AGREEMENTS

Scope in writing

Every engagement agreement must state clearly what it includes and what it doesn't. If you cover an application but not a possible Request for Evidence, an appeal or a hearing, write it down. Go over the agreement with your client out loud, in their language, and note in the file that you did. The most common dispute starts with an ambiguous scope.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **AI**

Ask AI to work only with the sources you provide. An open-ended prompt invites unfounded answers.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **NETWORKING**

A good referral includes context: what the person needs and why that professional is the right fit.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



EDUCATION

In immigration, what you learned a year ago may need review today. Confirm before applying it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Experience isn't how long you've practiced, but what you've reviewed and corrected in that time.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **DOCUMENTATION**
Name files with a fixed pattern: last name, document type and date. Order starts with the name.

Saturday *April 3*

DELEGATION
If you have to redo everything you delegate, review your instructions before judging your team.

Sunday *April 4*

CASE LAW
When a precedent hurts you, don't ignore it. Explain why the facts of your case are different.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Apr 5 – Apr 11, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

⚖️ HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • EXPECTATIONS

What you don't promise

In the first conversation, state clearly what you can't promise: processing times, outcomes, or decisions by the agency or the court. Explain what you do control: preparation, the quality of the filing and communication. Ask your client to tell you in their own words what they understood. Misplaced expectations are paid for later in complaints and distrust.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

An imperfect decision made on time is usually better than a perfect one that arrives late.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

When an error happens, first ask what allowed it, then who made it.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

ETHICS



What you file with an agency carries your name. Review every statement as if you had to defend it tomorrow.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📁 ORGANIZATION



At the end of each week, review which cases stalled and ask yourself why.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



RESEARCH

An AI tool can suggest leads, but every citation gets verified in the original source.

Saturday *April 10*

COMMUNICATION

Avoid jargon with clients. If you need a technical term, explain it once and always use it the same way.

Sunday *April 11*

SUPERVISION

A repeated error is rarely just one person's. Ask what part of the process allows it.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Apr 12 – Apr 18, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

👤 I MUST DELEGATE

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • EOIR

The court-ready folder

Every court case needs a working folder in the same order every time: notices, filings with proof of service, evidence, hearing notes and upcoming dates. Before each filing, confirm formatting and service rules in the current Practice Manual and official EOIR sources. A fixed order lets anyone on the team find everything.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES



INTAKE

Did you ask about prior filings and notices received? What the client doesn't mention matters, too.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES



CLIENTS

Return original documents you don't need to keep, and keep a record that you did.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



AI

Sounding confident doesn't make an answer correct. Verify every fact before it reaches a client.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



NETWORKING

Don't measure your network by number of contacts, but by how many people would take your call.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



EDUCATION

Set aside a fixed weekly block to study. If it has no place on your calendar, it has no place in your practice.

Saturday April 17

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Set aside a fixed hour each week to study. What has no schedule ends up not happening.

Sunday April 18

DOCUMENTATION

Proof of mailing is part of the mailing. File it with the copy of what was sent.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Apr 19 – Apr 25, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

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⚖️ HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • FOLLOW-UP

Nothing left hanging

Whenever you're waiting on something from someone, like a client document, an agency response or a signature, create a reminder right then with a date and an owner. Once a week, review the list of outside pending items and follow up. What has no follow-up date gets forgotten, and forgotten items tend to resurface when they're already urgent.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **DELEGATION**

Ask the person to restate the instruction in their own words. You'll catch misunderstandings early.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **CASE LAW**

Identify which court issued the decision. Its rank determines its weight in your case.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

When you set boundaries, your team learns to set them too.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

Hiding a mistake makes it bigger. Reporting it early almost always leaves more options.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

ETHICS
The client decides the goals of the case. Your job is to inform them well so they can decide clearly.

Saturday April 24 ORGANIZATION Before sending a package, check it against the index. What isn't checked gets lost.	Sunday April 25 RESEARCH Confirm that the authority you cite applies in the jurisdiction deciding the case.
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FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision	Something I need to correct
Something I learned	Something I won't carry into next week
Priority for next week	

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



MAY

— 2027 —



*Grow with intention,
not by accident.*



April reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value



May 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

May



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Improve your intake

- ☐ Review the questions in your general intake.
- ☐ Add screening for urgent matters and conflicts.
- ☐ Train whoever handles first contact on the difference between gathering information and giving advice.

MON	TUE	WED
26	27	28
3	4	5
10	11	12
17	18	19
24	25	26
31 ⚠ Memorial Day Verify closures	1	2

⚠ MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
29	30	1	2
6	7	8	9
13	14	15	16
20	21	22	23
27	28	29	30
3	4	5	6

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 LEARNING

 PERSONAL

 NOTES

This week

Apr 26 – May 2, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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3

🗓 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • PROCEDURES

Write down the process you repeat

Pick a task your team does every week and write it up as a procedure: numbered steps, who owns each step, which templates are used and how you check it was done right. Ask someone new to follow it without help and note where they got stuck. That's what's missing. A useful written procedure gets tested before it's filed away.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **COMMUNICATION**
Saying “I don’t know yet, but I’ll find out” builds more trust than an improvised answer.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **SUPERVISION**
Your signature on a document is yours, even if someone else prepared it. Read it as if you’d written it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

INTAKE



Check name spelling and date of birth before closing the intake. An error there travels through the whole file.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

CLIENTS



A client who asks the same thing several times may not need another answer, but a different explanation.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

AI



The tool can summarize a declaration; only you can judge whether it's credible and consistent with the rest of the file.

Saturday *May 1*

NETWORKING

Thank everyone who sends you a referral and, when appropriate, share how it went without revealing confidential information.

Sunday *May 2*

EDUCATION

To learn from a mistake, document it without blame and find which process failed.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

May 3 – May 9, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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🗂️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • AI

AI is an assistant, not an author

Use artificial intelligence to organize, summarize or write a first draft, never to decide. Before using it, confirm the tool protects confidentiality, and don't enter identifiable client data unless you're sure. Everything it produces goes through your professional review. Responsibility for the content is still yours.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

📌 *When the rule changes, go back to the source. Someone else's summary is a starting point, not a conclusion.*

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

DOCUMENTATION

📌 *Also document what the client decided not to do and that the consequences were explained.*

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DELEGATION

Not every task needs the same supervision. Match the review to the risk, not to your anxiety.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CASE LAW

When reading a decision, separate facts, question, rule and reasoning. That map helps you cite it well.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES



LEADERSHIP
An office's culture is defined by what you tolerate, not by what you hang on the wall.

Saturday <i>May 8</i> ERROR PREVENTION <i>If the same error repeats with different people, the problem is in the process.</i>	Sunday <i>May 9</i> ETHICS <i>An improvised interpreter can compromise confidentiality and accuracy. Choose carefully who interprets.</i>
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FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision Something I learned Priority for next week	Something I need to correct Something I won't carry into next week
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This week

May 10 – May 16, 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

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 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 DEADLINES

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

 TEAM

 ADMINISTRATIVE

 LEARNING

 PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

 I MUST DELEGATE

 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • AI PROMPTS

A good AI prompt has structure

Write your prompts in four parts: the role you want the tool to take on, the specific task, the necessary context without identifiable data and the output format. For example: "Organize this chronology into a table with date, event and supporting document." Save prompts that work in a shared team library so you don't start from scratch.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

ORGANIZATION

📁 *Would your team know what to do if you were out tomorrow? A good system doesn't rely on one person.*

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

RESEARCH

🔍 *Agency guidance reflects agency practice, but it doesn't replace reading the text behind it.*

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

COMMUNICATION

 Be honest about wait times: what depends on you, what depends on the agency and what no one controls.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

SUPERVISION

 Checklists don't replace professional judgment, but they keep fatigue from deciding for you.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



INTAKE

Receiving information with empathy isn't giving an opinion on the case. Listen, record and refer.

Saturday May 15

CLIENTS

Many clients lose a day of work to come to their appointment. Respect that by starting on time.

Sunday May 16

AI

Set office rules on which tasks may use AI and which may not. Without a clear policy, everyone improvises their own.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

May 17 – May 23, 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 DEADLINES

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

 TEAM

 ADMINISTRATIVE

 LEARNING

 PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

 I MUST DELEGATE

 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • VERIFICATION

Open every citation

If a text, whether from AI, a colleague or you, cites a decision, a regulation or a policy, open the source and confirm three things: that it exists, that it says what's claimed and that it's still current. AI tools can invent references that look perfect. No citation goes into a brief until someone has read it in the source.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 NETWORKING

Listening closely in a meeting beats handing out twenty business cards.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 EDUCATION

Choose instructors for their verifiable experience, not their number of followers.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Find someone who will review your work with a critical eye. Comfort rarely produces growth.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DOCUMENTATION

"Spoke with client" isn't a note. What was said, with whom and what was agreed is.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DELEGATION

Delegating without training transfers a problem. Training without delegating wastes talent.

Saturday *May 22*

CASE LAW

A decision from the circuit where the case arises can change the analysis. Always check the applicable jurisdiction.

Sunday *May 23*

LEADERSHIP

Before correcting, ask what happened. Many individual failures reveal a poorly designed process.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

May 24 – May 30, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

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🗓 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CONSULTATIONS

The consultation with an agenda

Before each consultation, review the intake and write down three goals: what you need to know, what the person needs to understand and what the next step will be. Use the last few minutes to summarize aloud what was discussed and agreed, and send that summary in writing. Legal consultations belong to attorneys or authorized representatives, never to support staff.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **ERROR PREVENTION**
Read important numbers aloud when checking them. The eye skips what the voice must pronounce.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **ETHICS**
Never fill in information the client didn't give you. If something is missing, ask; don't assume.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

ORGANIZATION

📁 Document every client call: date, who spoke and what was agreed. Three lines prevent many misunderstandings.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

RESEARCH

🔍 Save your research in a file organized by topic. Today's work may solve next month's case.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



COMMUNICATION

On WhatsApp, write as if the message will be printed and placed in the file. Sometimes it will be.

Saturday *May 29*

SUPERVISION

Schedule regular reviews of active cases. What no one looks at regularly tends to stall.

Sunday *May 30*

INTAKE

Ask for a copy of every USCIS or EOIR notice the client brings, even if they think it's unimportant.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



JUNE 2027



Pause. Evaluate. Refocus.

May reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value



June 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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3

CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

KEY DEADLINES

HEARINGS

INTAKES

CONSULTATIONS

FOLLOW-UPS

CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

LEARNING THIS MONTH

PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

June



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Audit your client communications

- ☐ Review one week of sent emails and messages.
- ☐ Check tone, clarity, language and confidentiality.
- ☐ Set official communication hours and channels.

MON

TUE

WED

31

1

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8

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14

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16

21

22

23

28

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30

MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
3	4	5	6
10	11	12	13
17	18 Juneteenth National Independence Day (observed) Verify closures	19	20
24	25	26	27
1	2	3	4

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🗓️ HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
🎓 LEARNING	📁 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

May 31 – Jun 6, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • HEARINGS

The rehearsal that eases fear

Prepare your client with a real rehearsal: who will be in the courtroom, where they'll sit, how interpretation works and what to do if they don't understand a question. Practice the hard questions without giving answers to memorize. Your goal is for them to tell the truth clearly and calmly. People who know what to expect testify better.

⚡ MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

 CLIENTS

If the client's information contradicts what they said before, ask with curiosity, not suspicion.

⚡ MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

 AI

When you use AI for a draft, record who reviewed it and what changed. Traceability protects your office, too.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

🔗 NETWORKING

🔗 Build relationships with professionals in other fields. Many immigration cases touch non-immigration issues.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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4

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

🎓 EDUCATION

🎓 Reading a full decision teaches more than reading someone's commentary on it.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Before weighing in on a new topic, ask where your knowledge of it comes from.

Saturday *June 5*

DOCUMENTATION

When you receive a document from the client, record the date received and who received it.

Sunday *June 6*

DELEGATION

A well-built template delegates part of the judgment without losing quality control.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jun 7 – Jun 13, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • TRANSLATIONS

Translations get reviewed, too

Every translation you file must be complete, include stamps, margin notes and handwritten text, and carry the certification required by the current official source. Have a second bilingual person compare names, dates and numbers against the original. A name translated two different ways in the same package can raise unnecessary doubts about identity.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **CASE LAW**
Cite every decision precisely. A sloppy cite costs the whole brief credibility.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **LEADERSHIP**
If every decision goes through you, you're not leading a team; you're managing a bottleneck.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

Does the client's name match on every page of the package, including the cover and exhibits?

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ETHICS

Does your advertising say exactly what you can do, or what clients would like to hear?

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 ORGANIZATION

Agency mail gets opened, scanned and logged the same day it arrives.

Saturday *June 12*

RESEARCH

If a tip from a forum or social media seems useful, treat it as a lead you still have to verify.

Sunday *June 13*

COMMUNICATION

A relative who interprets may filter, soften or leave things out. For sensitive topics, find someone neutral.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jun 14 – Jun 20, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CALENDAR

Internal deadline first

For each official deadline, also calendar an internal deadline with enough margin to review, correct and send without rushing. The internal deadline is the one the team works to; the official one is the safety net. Always calculate the official deadline using the current rule, verified in the appropriate source. Never plan to finish on the last day.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

SUPERVISION

☒ When the team makes a mistake, first ask how to fix it. Then ask how to keep it from happening again.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

INTAKE

 If intake reveals a possible urgent date, alert the attorney immediately. Don't wait for the weekly meeting.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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3

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

CLIENTS

🔗 *Boundaries protect the relationship, too. Set channels, hours and response times from the first meeting.*

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

🧠 **AI**
If you couldn't explain why an argument is right, don't include it just because AI suggested it.

Friday *June* 18

FEDERAL HOLIDAY: JUNETEENTH NATIONAL INDEPENDENCE DAY
(OBSERVED) • VERIFY CLOSURES

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	CALLS / EMAILS
1	
2	
3	NOTES
4	
5	
6	

 **NETWORKING**

If you promised to send something after a conversation, send it. Credibility is lost in small lapses.

Saturday <i>June 19</i> EDUCATION Continuing education isn't only legal. Communication, management and ethics also build your practice.	Sunday <i>June 20</i> PROFESSIONAL GROWTH Rehearsing a difficult interview beats improvising it, however talented you are.
---	--

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines

☐ Answered key communications

☐ Documented

☐ Reviewed open items

☐

Supervised

☐ Learned

☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jun 21 – Jun 27, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • EMAIL

A subject line you can find

Write every email subject so someone can find it with a search a year from now: client's last name, case type and action. For example: "Garcia – adjustment – pending documents." One topic per email; if you change topics, start a new thread. Before sending, check recipients and attachments. A wrong recipient is also a confidentiality problem.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **DOCUMENTATION**
An orderly file isn't cosmetic; it's the difference between finding evidence and losing it.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **DELEGATION**
When delegating, say which decisions must be escalated and which the person can make alone.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📖 CASE LAW

Recent decisions don't always replace earlier ones. Read how they relate before you conclude.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

💡 LEADERSHIP

Explain the why behind each procedure. People take better care of what they understand.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

Don't review a document right after drafting it. A few minutes' distance restores your critical eye.

Saturday *June 26*

ETHICS

A document preparer records what the client says; case strategy belongs to someone authorized to give it.

Sunday *June 27*

ORGANIZATION

Keep proof of every mailing and every receipt. Someday someone will ask you to prove it.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

Quarter in review

 CLIENTS

- Communication
- Expectations
- Complaints
- Follow-up

 CASES

- Backlog
- Deadlines
- Errors
- Outcomes

 TEAM

- Workload
- Supervision
- Training
- Feedback

 PROCESSES

- What works
- What's missing
- What to automate
- What to eliminate

 KNOWLEDGE

What I learned

What I need to learn

Courses

Case law

 SOCIAL CAPITAL

New people

Relationships

Referrals

Collaborations

 ME

What am I doing better?

What do I keep avoiding?

Where do I need help?

What must I not do
again?

In one sentence, this quarter was...

Office audit

AREA	NEEDS WORK	WORKS	STRONG	ACTION NEEDED
Calendar	☐	☐	☐	
Files	☐	☐	☐	
Case notes	☐	☐	☐	
Client communication	☐	☐	☐	
Deadlines	☐	☐	☐	
Billing	☐	☐	☐	
Supervision	☐	☐	☐	
Technology	☐	☐	☐	
Security	☐	☐	☐	
AI	☐	☐	☐	
Training	☐	☐	☐	
Closed cases	☐	☐	☐	

Third quarter 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 PROCESS I WILL IMPROVE

 WHAT I WILL LEARN

 RELATIONSHIP I WILL CULTIVATE

 PROJECT

 WHAT I WILL STOP DOING

 WHAT I WILL DELEGATE

 DATE OF MY NEXT REVIEW

 WHO I WILL REVIEW IT WITH

Mid-year review



Goals I set

My progress

Goals that are still relevant

Goals I should drop

My biggest achievement

My biggest lesson

My biggest mistake

The process that improved most

The person who most influenced my growth

The most useful course

The most useful book or resource

What needs to change in the next six months?

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



JULY

2027



*Make space for new ideas
and better decisions.*



June reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

July 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

July



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Train your team

- ☐ Ask your team what they need to learn.
- ☐ Organize a short training on one specific topic.
- ☐ Document what was taught for whoever comes next.

MON

TUE

WED

28

29

30

5

🔔 Independence Day (observed)
Verify closures

6

7

12

13

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19

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26

27

28

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
1	2	3	4
8	9	10	11
15	16	17	18
22	23	24	25
29	30	31	1

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🗓️ HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
🎓 LEARNING	📅 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

Jun 28 – Jul 4, 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

HEARINGS

INTAKES

CONSULTATIONS

DEADLINES

CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

TEAM

ADMINISTRATIVE

LEARNING

PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

I MUST DELEGATE

NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CONFLICTS

Check before you listen

Run the conflict check before the person shares the details of their case. Search your system for all relevant parties: the client, family members involved in the case, petitioners or employers, and adverse parties. Record who checked and the result. If a match comes up, the decision belongs to someone licensed or accredited, not to intake staff.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **RESEARCH**
Separate what the source says from how you interpret it. Mark them separately in your notes.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **COMMUNICATION**
End every meeting with a short recap: what was decided, what's pending and who owns it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

SUPERVISION

- ☒
- Teach the why behind each step. People who understand a procedure notice when something doesn't fit.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

INTAKE

- 
- Intake is the firm's first impression. How you ask determines how much the client will trust you when answering.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

**CLIENTS**

Don't confuse closeness with informality. Clients deserve warmth and professional treatment at once.

Saturday July 3

AI
A mistranslated proper name can create an inconsistency in the file. Check names, dates and places one by one.

Sunday July 4

NETWORKING
Keep a simple contact log: where you met, what you discussed and when you last followed up.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I need to correct

Something I learned

Something I won't carry into next week

Priority for next week

This week

Jul 5 – Jul 11, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

⚖️ HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • QUALITY CONTROL

The final-minutes checklist

Before sending any brief or application, run a short checklist: signatures in place, dates updated, correct form edition verified at the official source, payment or fee waiver as applicable, complete copies and proof of mailing ready. Have someone other than the preparer do it. A few minutes of review prevent months of corrections.

Monday

July

5

FEDERAL HOLIDAY: INDEPENDENCE DAY (OBSERVED) • VERIFY CLOSURES

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

 EDUCATION

Ask questions even if you think they're basic. Unresolved doubts turn into repeated errors.

Tuesday

July 6

DAY 187 • 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

 PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Keep your best briefs and worst mistakes. Both will have something to teach you a year from now.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📌 DOCUMENTATION

If you change a case instruction, note why. The reason is forgotten before the decision.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📌 DELEGATION

Reviewing delegated work isn't distrust; it's part of the system that protects the client.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CASE LAW

Does your argument rest on one decision? See whether other authorities support the same rule.

Saturday *July 10*

LEADERSHIP

Meetings need a purpose, an end time and clear owners for each agreement.

Sunday *July 11*

ERROR PREVENTION

Last-minute rush is fertile ground for errors. Set internal deadlines before the real one.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines

☐ Answered key communications

☐ Documented

☐ Reviewed open items

☐

Supervised

☐ Learned

☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jul 12 – Jul 18, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • USCIS INTERVIEWS

Make sure they know their file

Before an interview, go over everything filed on your client's behalf: forms, statements and evidence. Many problems arise because the person doesn't remember what they signed. Explain how the interview works, what to bring and how to ask for a question to be repeated. Never tell them what to answer; help them remember accurately and answer truthfully.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

⚖️

ETHICS

Bad news must be shared on time, too. Silence never protects the client.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

📁

ORGANIZATION

An organized intake saves the legal team hours. The right questions up front prevent corrections at the end.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



RESEARCH

A search with no results still teaches something: maybe the question needs different terms.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



COMMUNICATION

Silence communicates, too. A client who hears nothing about their case for weeks tends to imagine the worst.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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12 PM

1

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

SUPERVISION

- ☒ Define in writing which tasks each role can do and which need review by an attorney or accredited representative.

Saturday *July 17*

INTAKE

Ask for the client's preferred language from the first contact and record it where the whole team can see it.

Sunday *July 18*

CLIENTS

Ask clients to tell you right away if their address or phone changes. A missed notice can be costly.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

- ☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Jul 19 – Jul 25, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

⚖️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • FILE NAMING

One name, one standard

Define a single format for naming files and use it without exception. A useful example: date in year-month-day format, client's last name, document type and version. Files then sort themselves and anyone can find the right version. Ban names like “final,” “final2” or “new.” This week, rename the files for one case as a test.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **AI**
Ask AI where it got the information. If it can't show you the source, neither will you.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **NETWORKING**
A healthy network is reciprocal. Always asking and never giving wears it out.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



EDUCATION

Which topic do you avoid because it's hard? That's probably your next area of growth.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Growing means not repeating one year twenty times: review, adjust and try again.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **DOCUMENTATION**
Avoid files named “final,” “finalz” or “this one.” The right version should be clear without opening it.

Saturday *July 24*

DELEGATION
Give concrete feedback: what went well, what must change and why. Vague feedback fixes nothing.

Sunday *July 25*

CASE LAW
When the BIA and a federal court disagree, determine which controls in your jurisdiction before you argue.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



AUGUST

2027



*Consistency also builds
excellence.*

July reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value



August 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

August



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Review how you are using AI

- ☐ List the tools you use and what you use them for.
- ☐ Review what client information you share and how you protect it.
- ☐ Write or update your internal AI use policy.

MON	TUE	WED
26	27	28
2	3	4
9	10	11
16	17	18
23	24	25
30	31	1

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
29	30	31	1
5	6	7	8
12	13	14	15
19	20	21	22
26	27	28	29
2	3	4	5

🕒 KEY DEADLINES

🗓 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

🎓 LEARNING

📅 PERSONAL

📝 NOTES

This week

Jul 26 – Aug 1, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

⚖️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • RESEARCH

Research with a log

When you research a legal issue, keep a short log: the exact question, the sources consulted, the date checked and what you found in each. Start with official primary sources and use secondary ones for orientation. The log avoids repeat searches, lets someone else review your reasoning and protects the quality of your work.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES



LEADERSHIP
Admitting a mistake in front of your team gives others permission to do the same.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION
After fixing an error, update the checklist so the next one doesn't depend on memory.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📌 ETHICS

If a relative comes to the consultation, first confirm with the client what that person may hear.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📁 ORGANIZATION

Review your templates regularly. An outdated template repeats the same error in every case.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES



RESEARCH

Country conditions change. Update documentary evidence before each filing, not just when you open the case.

Saturday <i>July 31</i> COMMUNICATION Before answering an angry email, separate tone from content. Respond to the content.	Sunday <i>August 1</i> SUPERVISION Do you know which cases each person is handling today? If it's "more or less," check your system.
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FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Aug 2 – Aug 8, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • HARD CONVERSATIONS

Bad news in three steps

When you must deliver bad news, do it in three steps: say what happened clearly and directly, leave room for the reaction without filling it with explanations, and then explain the options and the next step. Do it in person or by phone, never by message alone. Afterward, document the conversation in the file.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **INTAKE**
Avoid phrases like “that’s easy” or “there’s no solution.” Neither one is intake’s call to make.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **CLIENTS**
Acknowledge case progress with the client, even small steps. It helps them endure the wait.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



AI

Client confidentiality isn't suspended because a tool is convenient or fast.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

NETWORKING



How long since you talked with a colleague you admire? A short note can reopen a valuable conversation.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **EDUCATION**

Take notes for your future self: notes you can find and understand when you need them.

Saturday August 7

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

A well-framed question to a colleague saves hours of research in the wrong direction.

Sunday August 8

DOCUMENTATION

Record the warnings you gave the client in the words you used, not your interpretation.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Aug 9 – Aug 15, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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⚖️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • SUPERVISION

The short case meeting

Schedule a brief, fixed weekly meeting to review cases with your team: what moved forward, what's stalled and what needs your decision. Legal questions staff have received from clients get resolved there or sooner, by someone authorized. Record decisions in the file. Consistent supervision keeps problems from growing in silence.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **DELEGATION**
If only you know how to do something, that process has a weak point with your name on it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **CASE LAW**
Reading case law regularly sharpens your judgment. Don't wait for a case to stay current.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

When did you last ask your team what obstacles they face? Listening is leading, too.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

Copying from a prior case saves time and also carries over another client's data. Check every field.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 ETHICS

Declining a case clearly and referring it well is also serving the community.

Saturday *August 14*

ORGANIZATION

Separate urgent from important, and schedule the important before it becomes urgent.

Sunday *August 15*

RESEARCH

When the answer seems too easy, check whether you missed an exception or an additional requirement.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Aug 16 – Aug 22, 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

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 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 DEADLINES

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

 TEAM

 ADMINISTRATIVE

 LEARNING

 PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

 I MUST DELEGATE

 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • ERRORS AND LESSONS

Review the error without blame

When an error happens, gather the team to answer three questions: what happened, why the process allowed it and what change will keep it from happening again. Look for the system failure before the person. Then update the written procedure or checklist. A team afraid to admit errors hides them, and hidden errors grow.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

COMMUNICATION

✍ Does your team use the same words to explain the same process? Consistency is part of the service, too.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

☒ **SUPERVISION**

A good team meeting is short, has an agenda and ends with owners assigned.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



INTAKE

Before you finish, go over your notes with the client. Fixing errors now avoids confusion later.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CLIENTS

A distressed client may not hear the first explanation. Repeat the essentials and give them in writing.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **AI**

Use AI to organize, not to decide. Case strategy requires judgment, context and accountability.

Saturday *August 21*

NETWORKING

Introducing two people who can help each other is a quiet form of leadership.

Sunday *August 22*

EDUCATION

A list of pending courses isn't a training plan. Prioritize, schedule and finish.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines

☐ Answered key communications

☐ Documented

☐ Reviewed open items

☐

Supervised

☐ Learned

☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Aug 23 – Aug 29, 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 DEADLINES

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 FOLLOW-UP

 TEAM

 ADMINISTRATIVE

 LEARNING

 PERSONAL

 I MUST FINISH

 I MUST DELEGATE

 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CLIENT EXPERIENCE

They always know where they stand

Your client should be able to answer three questions at any time: what stage their case is in, what is being waited on and what they need to do. If they can't, your communication has a gap. Send a short update at every stage change, even if there's no news from the agency. Silence creates anxiety and calls; a clear line creates trust.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **PROFESSIONAL GROWTH**
When did you last change a work habit because you found a better one?

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **DOCUMENTATION**
Notes should capture facts, dates and agreements. Personal impressions don't replace data.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DELEGATION

Delegating client communication requires defining what can be said and what must be checked first.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CASE LAW

An appealing quote taken out of context can backfire if the decision-maker reads the full opinion.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

Hire for values and judgment. Technical skills are easier to teach than ethics.

Saturday *August 28*

ERROR PREVENTION

Verify the mailing address every time. Being right on the last case doesn't make it right today.

Sunday *August 29*

ETHICS

Client money you haven't earned yet isn't yours. Handle it with that in mind.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



SEPTEMBER

— 2027 —



*Learning is also part
of leading.*



August reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

September 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

September



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Update your legal library

- ☐ Review your saved resources and remove anything outdated.
- ☐ Verify that the sources you use most are still current.
- ☐ Record the verification date in your library.

MON

TUE

WED

30

31

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6

🔔 Labor Day
Verify closures

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29

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
2	3	4	5
9	10	11	12
16	17	18	19
23	24	25	26
30	1	2	3

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🏛️ HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
🎓 LEARNING	📅 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

Aug 30 – Sep 5, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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🗂️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • LEADERSHIP

Explain the why

When you ask your team to follow a procedure, explain why it exists: what risk it prevents, what problem it solved before or what it protects. People follow what they understand. This week, pick an office rule that's often broken and explain its reason at the team meeting. Then ask what makes it hard to follow and listen to the answer.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **ORGANIZATION**
A short weekly team meeting is worth more than ten scattered messages throughout the day.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **RESEARCH**
Consult the official version of the rule, not an undated copy with no source.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

COMMUNICATION

🔗 *Listening well includes noticing what the client avoids saying. Sometimes the most important part comes at the end.*

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

SUPERVISION

☑ *Useful feedback is specific: point to the document, the error and the correction you expect.*

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

INTAKE

 Ask how they prefer to be contacted and if it's safe to leave messages at that number. Confidentiality starts there.

Saturday *September 4*

CLIENTS

If the client brings advice from neighbors or social media, don't dismiss it. Calmly explain why their case may differ.

Sunday *September 5*

AI

Before adopting a new tool, test it with fictional information and calmly evaluate its errors.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Sep 6 – Sep 12, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗓 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • WELL-BEING

Fatigue makes mistakes, too

This work exposes you to hard stories and constant pressure, and fatigue shows first in quality. Learn your signals: rereading without understanding, putting off calls, getting irritated easily. When they appear, save critical review for another time and seek support. This week, schedule a real break, with no email, and honor it like a client appointment.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

 NETWORKING

When a matter is outside your area, admitting it and referring well is client service, not a loss.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

 EDUCATION

Learning alongside colleagues creates shared accountability and conversations a video can't give you.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Studying professional ethics isn't a requirement to check off; it's a compass to calibrate.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

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3

4

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DOCUMENTATION

Where is it recorded that the client got a copy of the filing? If you don't know, that's today's task.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DELEGATION

Does your team know when to interrupt you? A clear rule prevents dangerous silence and needless questions.

Saturday *September 11*

CASE LAW

*Changes in case law can affect cases already open.
Review your caseload when a relevant decision comes out.*

Sunday *September 12*

LEADERSHIP

An exhausted leader makes worse decisions. Your rest protects your clients, too.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Sep 13 – Sep 19, 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES

-
-
-

HEARINGS

INTAKES

CONSULTATIONS

DEADLINES

CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

TEAM

ADMINISTRATIVE

LEARNING

PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • MENTORING

Ask for mentoring with questions

Good mentoring doesn't start with "Can you help me?" but with a concrete question: how you organize your hearings, how you structure your fees, how you supervise new staff. Bring your questions in writing and respect the agreed time. If you're already experienced, offer an hour a month to someone starting out. Teaching also forces you to organize your practice.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

ⓘ

ERROR PREVENTION

A missing signature can undo hours of work. Make it a mandatory item in your final review.

🔑 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

⚖️

ETHICS

When a client request makes you ethically uneasy, stop, document and consult before acting.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📁 ORGANIZATION

Decide who can edit each final document. Multiple versions are a silent source of errors.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

🔍 RESEARCH

Before using someone else's brief as a model, check every authority in it as if citing it for the first time.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **COMMUNICATION**
Confirm important verbal agreements in writing. Two people's memories rarely match.

Saturday *September 18*

SUPERVISION
Supervising also means protecting the team from overload. An exhausted person makes errors no one wants.

Sunday *September 19*

INTAKE
An incomplete intake shifts work to the attorney and delays the consultation. Complete what you can from first contact.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Sep 20 – Sep 26, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗓 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CONTINUING EDUCATION

Your own training plan

Don't wait until your continuing education deadline approaches to choose courses. Write down three areas you want to strengthen this year and find specific training for each. After each course, note one practice you'll change in your office and apply it that same week. For your non-attorney team, prioritize training in processes and ethical boundaries.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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4

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **CLIENTS**
Does your office know what to do when a client gets upset? Improvising then rarely goes well.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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4

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6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **AI**
AI doesn't know your client. You do. That difference should show in every document you prepare.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



NETWORKING

A professional association pays off when you get involved, not just when you pay dues.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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5

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



EDUCATION

Turn what you learn into a tool: a checklist, a template or an internal protocol.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Listen to how someone more experienced analyzes a case. Method is learned by watching the reasoning.

Saturday *September 25*

DOCUMENTATION

Documenting as you work takes minutes; reconstructing later can take days and still be incomplete.

Sunday *September 26*

DELEGATION

Expand someone's autonomy when their results justify it, and put it in writing.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐ Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

Quarter in review

 CLIENTS

- Communication
- Expectations
- Complaints
- Follow-up

 CASES

- Backlog
- Deadlines
- Errors
- Outcomes

 TEAM

- Workload
- Supervision
- Training
- Feedback

 PROCESSES

- What works
- What's missing
- What to automate
- What to eliminate

 KNOWLEDGE

What I learned

What I need to learn

Courses

Case law

 SOCIAL CAPITAL

New people

Relationships

Referrals

Collaborations

 ME

What am I doing better?

What do I keep avoiding?

Where do I need help?

What must I not do
again?

In one sentence, this quarter was...

Office audit

AREA	NEEDS WORK	WORKS	STRONG	ACTION NEEDED
Calendar	☐	☐	☐	
Files	☐	☐	☐	
Case notes	☐	☐	☐	
Client communication	☐	☐	☐	
Deadlines	☐	☐	☐	
Billing	☐	☐	☐	
Supervision	☐	☐	☐	
Technology	☐	☐	☐	
Security	☐	☐	☐	
AI	☐	☐	☐	
Training	☐	☐	☐	
Closed cases	☐	☐	☐	

Fourth quarter 2027

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 PROCESS I WILL IMPROVE

 WHAT I WILL LEARN

 RELATIONSHIP I WILL CULTIVATE

 PROJECT

 WHAT I WILL STOP DOING

 WHAT I WILL DELEGATE

 DATE OF MY NEXT REVIEW

 WHO I WILL REVIEW IT WITH

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



OCTOBER

2027



*Strengthen your processes.
Protect your time.*



September reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

October 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

October



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH

Review your deadline system

- ☐ Take three recent deadlines and reconstruct how they were calculated and entered.
- ☐ Confirm there was a double check.
- ☐ Fix any step that depends on one person's memory.

MON

TUE

WED

27

28

29

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11

📅 Columbus Day
Verify closures

12

13

18

19

20

25

26

27

📅 MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
30	1	2	3
7	8	9	10
14	15	16	17
21	22	23	24
28	29	30	31

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🏛️ HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
🎓 LEARNING	📅 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

Sep 27 – Oct 3, 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

HEARINGS

INTAKES

CONSULTATIONS

DEADLINES

CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

TEAM

ADMINISTRATIVE

LEARNING

PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • NETWORKING

Relationships before you need them

Build your professional network before you need it. This week, contact two colleagues: one who practices in an area complementary to yours and one from a community organization. Offer something useful, like a resource, an introduction or an invitation, before asking for anything. Log each contact with date and topic. Networks thrive on follow-up, not business cards.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **CASE LAW**

Keep a log of the decisions you use most and update it when later authority affects them.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **LEADERSHIP**

Define what good work looks like before judging whether someone achieved it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

Did you check that the dates in the declaration match those in the supporting documents?

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

ETHICS



A foreign law degree doesn't authorize practice here. Always describe yourself by what you're authorized to do.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 ORGANIZATION

Request documents from clients with a clear list and a due date. Vague requests get incomplete answers.

Saturday *October 2*

RESEARCH

Can you explain what you found in two sentences? If not, your research isn't finished.

Sunday *October 3*

COMMUNICATION

A message template saves time; personalizing it keeps the client from feeling like a number.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I need to correct

Something I learned

Something I won't carry into next week

Priority for next week

This week

Oct 4 – Oct 10, 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES

- 1 _____
- 2 _____
- 3 _____

HEARINGS

INTAKES

CONSULTATIONS

DEADLINES

CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

TEAM

ADMINISTRATIVE

LEARNING

PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • REFERRALS

Refer with judgment

Keep an updated list of colleagues and organizations you refer the cases you don't take to, with their practice area and contact information. When you refer, explain why, give the information in writing and document in the file that you didn't take on the representation. Verify that whoever receives the referral holds a current license or accreditation for that type of case.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

SUPERVISION

☒ Before blaming anyone for a missed deadline, check whether it was logged where everyone could see it.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **INTAKE**

If the client comes with a relative, confirm who you may discuss the case with and put it in writing.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 CLIENTS

When a case has no viable path, saying so clearly is also a service to the client.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 AI

Train your team to verify before you train them to generate. Speed without review multiplies errors.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



NETWORKING

Talk about your work clearly and without exaggeration. Professional trust starts with accuracy.

Saturday *October 9*

EDUCATION

Study the cases that didn't go well, too. They often teach more than the successes.

Sunday *October 10*

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Turn every recurring question into an internal guide. What you explain ten times belongs in writing.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

- ☐ Met my deadlines
- ☐ Answered key communications
- ☐ Documented
- ☐ Reviewed open items
- ☐
- Supervised
- ☐ Learned
- ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Oct 11 – Oct 17, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗓 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CLOSING FILES

Closing is service, too

Every file closes with a letter stating that representation has ended, what the outcome was, which original documents were returned and what future dates your client must watch on their own. Verify that no active deadline remains on the calendar. Archive according to your retention policy. A clear closing prevents misunderstandings and protects the office.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

 DOCUMENTATION

Every important email with the client deserves a copy in the file, not just in the inbox.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	
1	CALLS / EMAILS
2	
3	
4	NOTES
5	
6	

 DELEGATION

A due date with no time or format leaves room for two different interpretations.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CASE LAW

Presenting precedent honestly, limits included, builds your credibility with the decision-maker.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

Saying no to a new project means saying yes to the quality of the ones you have.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

Changing the person without changing the process just brings the error back under a new name.

Saturday *October 16*

ETHICS

When your office made the mistake, tell the client as clearly as you would share good news.

Sunday *October 17*

ORGANIZATION

Your inbox is not a case management system. Move every task to where the team can see it.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Oct 18 – Oct 24, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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🗓 HEARINGS

📝 INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

📝 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • CALENDAR

The Friday practice review

Every Friday, review the next four weeks of the calendar with the person in charge of deadlines. Confirm that each date has an owner, an internal deadline and a preparation status. Look for conflicts: two hearings on the same day, a big filing during a vacation week. What you catch a month ahead is an adjustment; what you catch on Monday is a crisis.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **RESEARCH**
Read the footnotes. Sometimes the limit that changes everything is there.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **COMMUNICATION**
When a document arrives incomplete, explain what's missing and why it matters, so the client won't repeat it.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



SUPERVISION

Ask the team to flag questions early. A timely question costs less than a late correction.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



INTAKE

Ask sensitive questions in a private space, calmly, explaining why they're needed.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 CLIENTS

Warn clients about people who offer guaranteed results. Protecting them from fraud is part of your job, too.

Saturday *October 23*

AI

A good AI prompt defines the task, the format, the permitted sources and what the tool must not do.

Sunday *October 24*

NETWORKING

Relationships with staff at other offices matter, too. Respect shows in every call.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

- ☐ Met my deadlines
- ☐ Answered key communications
- ☐ Documented
- ☐ Reviewed open items
- ☐
- Supervised
- ☐ Learned
- ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Oct 25 – Oct 31, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

⚖️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • INTAKE

Red flags

Train intake staff to recognize and flag signals that need immediate attorney attention: an upcoming court date, a detained person, a notice received but unopened, or a deadline mentioned in passing. Their job isn't to evaluate the signal but to record it and escalate it the same day. Keep that list printed and visible at every intake station.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 EDUCATION

The certificate proves you attended. Practice proves you learned.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Saying “let me confirm” is more professional than answering fast and correcting later.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DOCUMENTATION

Date and sign every note. A record with no author or date loses most of its value.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DELEGATION

When delegating, share an example of work done well. A model is worth more than a description.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



CASE LAW

A precedent answers a specific question. Before extending it, confirm your question is the same.

Saturday *October 30*

LEADERSHIP

Matching what you ask with what you do is the basis of your authority.

Sunday *October 31*

ERROR PREVENTION

Log every significant error and its cause. An honest history is your best prevention tool.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines

☐ Answered key communications

☐ Documented

☐ Reviewed open items

☐

Supervised

☐ Learned

☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



NOVEMBER

2027



*Recognize what you have
learned and built.*

October reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

November 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

November



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH
Analyze the year's errors and lessons

- ☐ Reread your log of errors and lessons.
- ☐ Group errors by cause, not by person.
- ☐ Choose the three processes you will change in 2028.

MON	TUE	WED
1	2	3
8	9	10
15	16	17
22	23	24
29	30	1

MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

1
 2
 3

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
4	5	6	7
11 🇺🇸 Veterans Day Verify closures	12	13	14
18	19	20	21
25 🇺🇸 Thanksgiving Day Verify closures	26	27	28
2	3	4	5

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🏛️ HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
🎓 LEARNING	👤 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

Nov 1 – Nov 7, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • FILE NOTES

Facts, not impressions

In file notes, write facts, not impressions. Instead of “he was confused,” write what the person asked or said. Distinguish what your client reported from what you verified with a document. Avoid opinions about anyone's credibility or character. Remember that a note may be read years later by someone who wasn't there.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **ETHICS**
A client's rush doesn't lessen your duties. It calls for more care.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **ORGANIZATION**
Before going on vacation, leave in writing the status of each case and who is covering it.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



RESEARCH

Share what you learned in your research with your team. Knowledge that stays in one head gets lost.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



COMMUNICATION

Treat whoever comes with the client with the same respect as the client. Both are watching how you work.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

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4

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6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

☒ **SUPERVISION**
Listen now and then to how your staff answers the phone. That's where the office's real culture shows.

Saturday November 6

INTAKE
Does your intake script make clear that the initial conversation isn't legal advice? It should.

Sunday November 7

CLIENTS
Trust is built through small follow-throughs: returning the call, sending the copy, being on time.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐
Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Nov 8 – Nov 14, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • BIA

The record governs

Before drafting any appeal argument, read the entire record: the transcript, the court's decision and all admitted evidence. Build an index with the page where each fact you'll use appears. An argument without an exact record cite loses force. Confirm filing, formatting and deadline rules in current official sources.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **AI**

Did you review the final version or just the first one? Each new generation can introduce new errors.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **NETWORKING**

Prepare before an event: decide whom you want to meet and what you want to ask.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

EDUCATION

🎓 *Review your templates whenever you learn something new. An outdated document repeats the error every day.*

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

🍃 *After a hearing or interview, spend five minutes noting what you'd do differently.*

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DOCUMENTATION

When a conversation changes the case strategy, confirm it in writing with the client.

Saturday *November 13*

DELEGATION

What you delegate in a rush at the end of the day rarely gets the attention it needs.

Sunday *November 14*

CASE LAW

When the case law is unsettled, say so. Explaining that risk clearly is also good representation.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Nov 15 – Nov 21, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • QUALITY CONTROL

Three review passes

To catch the errors your brain auto-corrects, review every important document in three separate passes: one for content and logic, one only for names, dates and numbers, and one on paper or aloud for the writing. If you can, let a day pass between passes. The writer sees what they meant to write; review looks for what was actually written.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **LEADERSHIP**

Train someone who can replace you in a key task. A strong office doesn't depend on one person.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **ERROR PREVENTION**

Before sending, check the complete package against the index. Missing items rarely stand out.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📌 ETHICS

Before using a case as an example online or in class, remove anything that could identify the person.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📁 ORGANIZATION

Back up your data in more than one place, and check now and then that the backup actually works.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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11

12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



RESEARCH

For country conditions evidence, prefer recognized, dated, verifiable sources, and cite each one precisely.

Saturday November 20

COMMUNICATION

Clear internal communication keeps a client from getting two different answers from the same office.

Sunday November 21

SUPERVISION

When a procedure changes, announce it, explain it and check that it's followed. Announcing isn't enough.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Nov 22 – Nov 28, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗓 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • VERIFICATION

The identity sheet

Before preparing any form, create an identity sheet for the case: full name exactly as it appears on each document, dates of birth, immigration ID numbers and known name variations. Verify each item against the original and explain discrepancies in the file. That sheet becomes the single reference for the whole team.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES



INTAKE

Before hearing the full story, confirm there's no conflict of interest with another client of the firm.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES



CLIENTS

Ask the client what worries them most. Their priority may not be the one you assumed.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



AI

If AI edits the style of a declaration, confirm it didn't change the meaning or the declarant's voice.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



NETWORKING

When a colleague makes a public mistake, your discretion says more about you than any comment.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



EDUCATION

When you teach someone, ask them to explain what they understood. That confirms the message landed.

Saturday November 27

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Knowledge you don't share with your team is absent with you the day you're out.

Sunday November 28

DOCUMENTATION

If you're shown an original you don't keep, scan a copy and note who holds the original.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

My intention for the month

 ONE WORD FOR THIS MONTH

 WHAT I WANT TO ACHIEVE

 HOW I WANT TO FEEL AT THE END OF THE MONTH

 WHAT I WILL DO DIFFERENTLY

 NOTES



DECEMBER

2027



*Close the year with clarity,
gratitude, and vision.*



November reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

December 2027



 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

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3

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

 KEY DEADLINES

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 FOLLOW-UPS

 CLIENTS OWING DOCUMENTS

 DOCUMENTS I AM WAITING FOR

 OUTSTANDING ACCOUNTS / FEES

 LEARNING THIS MONTH

 PROCESS I WANT TO IMPROVE

 SOMETHING I SHOULD DELEGATE

 PERSON I SHOULD CONNECT WITH

December



PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE OF THE MONTH
Design your next professional year

- ☐ Complete your year-end review.
- ☐ Set your priorities for 2028.
- ☐ Schedule your learning and rest blocks now.

MON	TUE	WED
29	30	1
6	7	8
13	14	15
20	21	22
27	28	29

MY 3 PRIORITIES FOR THE MONTH

MY TIME

DECEMBER

THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
2	3	4	5
9	10	11	12
16	17	18	19
23	24 ⚠ Christmas Day (observed) Verify closures	25	26
30	31 ⚠ New Year's Day 2028 (observed) Verify closures	1	2

🕒 KEY DEADLINES	🗓 HEARINGS	📝 INTAKES
🎓 LEARNING	👤 PERSONAL	📝 NOTES

This week

Nov 29 – Dec 5, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂️ HEARINGS

✍️ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

🕒 DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑️ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑️ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍️ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • PROCEDURES

Procedures that stay alive

Spend this month reviewing your written procedures. For each one, ask: is it followed in practice, does it reflect the current rule verified in the official source, and who updates it when something changes? Delete the ones no one uses and fix the ones the team changed without writing it down. An outdated procedure can be more dangerous than having none.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **DELEGATION**
Delegating well frees your time for what only you can do: analyze, decide and guide.

MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **CASE LAW**
Before calling an issue settled, check whether it's still being litigated in other courts.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

A difficult conversation put off almost always becomes more difficult.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



ERROR PREVENTION

Confidence in your work doesn't replace verification; it only makes it faster.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 ETHICS

Supervising isn't a final check. It's being available and attentive while the work is done.

Saturday *December 4*

ORGANIZATION

When a client changes address or phone, updating every record is a same-day task.

Sunday *December 5*

RESEARCH

Good research also means knowing when to stop: when sources start repeating, it's time to write.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Dec 6 – Dec 12, 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

HEARINGS

INTAKES

CONSULTATIONS

DEADLINES

CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

TEAM

ADMINISTRATIVE

LEARNING

PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

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Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • WELL-BEING

December with boundaries

December brings anxious clients, office closures and accumulated fatigue. Decide your boundaries now: which days you won't answer messages, who will cover emergencies and how the schedule will be communicated to clients. Give notice early. Protecting your rest also protects the people you represent, because no one reviews a file well with a whole year's fatigue on their shoulders.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

COMMUNICATION

📝 *If the client has trouble reading, the clearest text isn't enough. Offer to explain it aloud and check understanding.*

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

☒ **SUPERVISION**

Example supervises more than any manual. If you improvise, your team will learn to improvise.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

INTAKE



A prospective client in a hurry needs you to listen in an orderly way. Your calm helps them remember what matters.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

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12 PM

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CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

CLIENTS



Give the client a copy of everything filed for them. Knowing their own file gives them peace of mind and control.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

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12 PM

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FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 **AI**

Explaining to clients how you use technology in their case is part of a transparent relationship.

Saturday *December 11*

NETWORKING

Celebrate your colleagues' wins. Recognizing others' work strengthens the profession.

Sunday *December 12*

EDUCATION

Invest in training your support staff. The quality of a file depends on the whole team.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Dec 13 – Dec 19, 2027

MY 3 PRIORITIES

1 _____

2 _____

3 _____

HEARINGS

INTAKES

CONSULTATIONS

DEADLINES

CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

TEAM

ADMINISTRATIVE

LEARNING

PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

I MUST DELEGATE

NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • EXPECTATIONS

Give notice before closing

Before the holidays, tell each active client in writing when the office will be closed, how to reach you in a real emergency and which steps in their case may be delayed. Check which cases have upcoming dates and confirm them with the team. A clear expectation before closing prevents anxious messages during the holidays and a backlog of calls when you return.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **PROFESSIONAL GROWTH**
Measure your progress by the quality of your questions, not just the number of cases handled.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **DOCUMENTATION**
An identical folder structure for every case lets anyone find what they need.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

DELEGATION

Close each delegated task with a final review. Delegating doesn't end when the work is handed in.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

CASE LAW

The deference a court gives an agency can change. Check how the issue is treated today before you argue it.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



LEADERSHIP

Assign each task an owner and a date. An agreement without an owner rarely gets done.

Saturday *December 18*

ERROR PREVENTION

A culture where no one admits mistakes has no fewer errors, just less information about them.

Sunday *December 19*

ETHICS

Can your client repeat, in their own words, what you agreed on today? If not, consent isn't complete yet.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Dec 20 – Dec 26, 2027

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

🗂 HEARINGS

✍ INTAKES

👤 CONSULTATIONS

⌚ DEADLINES

📁 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☑ FOLLOW-UP

👥 TEAM

📁 ADMINISTRATIVE

📖 LEARNING

🍃 PERSONAL

☑ I MUST FINISH

👥 I MUST DELEGATE

✍ NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • SUPERVISION

Coverage without gaps

Before anyone on the team goes on vacation, prepare a coverage sheet: active cases, dates for the coming weeks, outside pending items and who takes over each one. The person covering must have access to the files and know which decisions require the authorized person. Review the sheet together before the departure, not by email on the last afternoon.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 ORGANIZATION

Time spent hunting for documents measures the health of your office's system.

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

 RESEARCH

If someone without a license does the research, the supervisor reviews the conclusions before they reach the client.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

📌

COMMUNICATION

Answering fast isn't always answering well. Take the minute you need to review before sending.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES

☑

SUPERVISION

Trusting your team and checking its work don't conflict. Both are part of one professional duty.

MY 3 PRIORITIES

CASES / TASKS

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



INTAKE

Intake isn't a minor step. It's when you gather the facts the entire case is built on.

Saturday *December 25*

CLIENTS

When closing a case, explain what comes next and which documents to keep. A good closing is service, too.

Sunday *December 26*

AI

AI saves time on drafting. Invest it in review.

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines ☐ Answered key communications ☐ Documented ☐ Reviewed open items ☐

Supervised ☐ Learned ☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

This week

Dec 27, 2027 – Jan 2, 2028

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 HEARINGS

 INTAKES

 CONSULTATIONS

 DEADLINES

 CASES THAT NEED ATTENTION

☒ FOLLOW-UP

 TEAM

 ADMINISTRATIVE

 LEARNING

 PERSONAL

☒ I MUST FINISH

 I MUST DELEGATE

 NOTES FOR THE WEEK

CASE REVIEW

Case needing the most attention

Stalled case

Client waiting

Pending document

Upcoming deadline

Case to discuss with someone

Case I can close

What could become a problem next week if I don't handle it today?



MICRO-LESSON OF THE WEEK • YEAR-END

Close the year, open the next

Spend an afternoon closing out the year with four questions: which cases or processes worked best, which mistake you don't want to repeat, which procedure you need to write or fix and what training your team needs. Then move all pending deadlines and follow-ups to the new calendar, verified against the file. Start January with confirmed dates, not memories.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **NETWORKING**
If you can't help someone, say so early and, if possible, point them to someone who can.

📌 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE 8 AM 9 10 11 12 PM 1 2 3 4 5 6	FOLLOW-UP DEADLINES CALLS / EMAILS NOTES

 **EDUCATION**
Learning calmly and in depth pays off more than cramming before every deadline.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

Intellectual humility isn't insecurity; it's the willingness to verify before asserting.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES

SCHEDULE

8 AM

9

10

11

12 PM

1

2

3

4

5

6

CASES / TASKS

FOLLOW-UP

DEADLINES

CALLS / EMAILS

NOTES



DOCUMENTATION

What you can't prove with a record, you'll have to defend with your word alone. Better to have the record.

🔔 MY 3 PRIORITIES	CASES / TASKS
SCHEDULE	FOLLOW-UP
8 AM	
9	
10	DEADLINES
11	
12 PM	CALLS / EMAILS
1	
2	
3	NOTES
4	
5	
6	

 **DELEGATION**

Define in writing where each role ends. Front-desk staff need to know what they shouldn't answer.

Saturday <i>January 1, 2028</i>	Sunday <i>January 2, 2028</i>
--	--

FRIDAY PRACTICE REVIEW

☐ Met my deadlines

☐ Answered key communications

☐ Documented

☐ Reviewed open items

☐

Supervised

☐ Learned

☐ Followed up

My best decision

Something I learned

Priority for next week

Something I need to correct

Something I won't carry into next week

Quarter in review

 CLIENTS

- Communication
- Expectations
- Complaints
- Follow-up

 CASES

- Backlog
- Deadlines
- Errors
- Outcomes

 TEAM

- Workload
- Supervision
- Training
- Feedback

 PROCESSES

- What works
- What's missing
- What to automate
- What to eliminate

 KNOWLEDGE

What I learned

What I need to learn

Courses

Case law

 SOCIAL CAPITAL

New people

Relationships

Referrals

Collaborations

 ME

What am I doing better?

What do I keep avoiding?

Where do I need help?

What must I not do
again?

In one sentence, this quarter was...

Office audit

AREA	NEEDS WORK	WORKS	STRONG	ACTION NEEDED
Calendar	☐	☐	☐	
Files	☐	☐	☐	
Case notes	☐	☐	☐	
Client communication	☐	☐	☐	
Deadlines	☐	☐	☐	
Billing	☐	☐	☐	
Supervision	☐	☐	☐	
Technology	☐	☐	☐	
Security	☐	☐	☐	
AI	☐	☐	☐	
Training	☐	☐	☐	
Closed cases	☐	☐	☐	

QUARTER PLAN

First quarter 2028

 MY 3 PRIORITIES

1

2

3

 PROCESS I WILL IMPROVE

 WHAT I WILL LEARN

 RELATIONSHIP I WILL CULTIVATE

 PROJECT

 WHAT I WILL STOP DOING

 WHAT I WILL DELEGATE

 DATE OF MY NEXT REVIEW

 WHO I WILL REVIEW IT WITH

December reset

What worked?

Where did I lose time?

What should I stop doing?

What did I learn?

Who did I meet?

Which course did I advance?

What mistake do I not want to repeat?

What didn't work?

What process do I need?

What should I delegate?

What does my team need to learn?

Which relationship should I cultivate?

What did I read?

My main lesson of the month

 PEOPLE I MET THIS MONTH

NAME	WHERE WE MET	WHAT THEY DO	FOLLOW-UP

- ☐ Saved the contact
- ☐ Connected on LinkedIn
- ☐ Sent a message
- ☐ Followed up
- ☐ Found a way to add value

My 2027 in review

CASES

LEARNING

CONTINUING LEGAL EDUCATION (CLE)

MENTORING

TEAM

ERRORS

CHALLENGES

CLIENTS

COURSES

BOOKS

PROFESSIONAL NETWORK

PROCESSES

ACHIEVEMENTS

Questions to close the year

What did I do well?

What would I do differently?

What did I learn about my practice?

What did I learn about myself?

What will I not do again?

Which system do I want to carry into next year?

What do I want to leave behind?





MY CASES



How to use this section

These tools follow a case from first contact to closing. They do not replace your case management system or the file: they help you think, prepare and verify before you act.



Pages marked with this symbol contain analysis or decisions that belong only to an attorney or authorized representative. The rest of the team can prepare information and follow up under supervision.

TOOL	WHAT IT IS FOR	WHO USES IT
Intake		
Consultation planner		
Meeting agenda		
Case strategy		
Case timeline		
Hearing preparation		
Interview preparation		
Quality control		
Deadline log		
Communication log		
What I am waiting for		
Case closing		

Many of these pages are templates. Make copies or download the printables when they are available in the digital library.



How to design a good intake

A good intake is not a long interrogation. It is the minimum correct information to know who the person is, what they need and what cannot wait.

Design your intake so that anyone on the team gets the same information, in the same order, without giving an opinion on the case. It should help you identify:

WHAT TO IDENTIFY	WHY IT MATTERS
Who the person is	
What they want	
Entries	
Departures	
Current status	
Immigration history	
Family	
Criminal history	
Prior proceedings	
Orders	
Fraud or misrepresentation	
Missing information	

Questions about criminal history, orders or possible misrepresentation are gathered carefully and without judgment. Analyzing them belongs to the authorized person.

 NOTES

Gathering information is not giving advice

Gathering information

- Ask about facts, dates and documents.
- Write down what the person says, in their own words.
- Identify urgent matters and possible deadlines.
- Schedule the consultation with the authorized person.
- Explain the office's internal process.

Giving legal advice

- Saying which immigration option is best for them.
- Assessing whether they qualify for something.
- Explaining the risks of a specific decision.
- Recommending a form or a filing.
- Promising or estimating an outcome.

Attorney or authorized representative only.

The phrase my team uses when asked for an opinion

Urgency signs that always trigger immediate review

Red flags that are escalated to the authorized person

Who reviews each intake and within what time frame

 NOTES

General Immigration Intake

Who the person is

What they want

Departures from the U.S.

Immigration history

Criminal history

Orders

Missing information

 QUESTIONS TO INCLUDE

QUESTIONS TO INCLUDE

Removal · Bond

QUESTIONS TO INCLUDE

 QUESTIONS TO INCLUDE

Naturalization · TPS

QUESTIONS TO INCLUDE

QUESTIONS TO INCLUDE

Humanitarian · Motions

QUESTIONS TO INCLUDE

 QUESTIONS TO INCLUDE

Consultation

CLIENT	DATE	TIME	LANGUAGE
CONSULTATION TYPE		REFERRED BY	

Before

VERIFY	DONE	NOTES
Conflict check	☐	
Intake complete	☐	
Documents received	☐	
A-number	☐	
Immigration history	☐	
EOIR, if applicable	☐	
USCIS notices	☐	
Client's goal	☐	

During

What does the client want to achieve?

Entries	Status

NOTES

Consultation · continued

Immigration history

Criminal history

Orders

Family

Prior proceedings

Red flags



This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

Possible options

Missing information

After

STEP	DONE	DETAIL
Note to file	☐	
Engagement or declination letter	☐	
Documents requested	☐	
Follow-up	☐	
Next action	☐	

NOTES

Consultation

CLIENT	DATE	TIME	LANGUAGE
CONSULTATION TYPE		REFERRED BY	

Before

VERIFY	DONE	NOTES
Conflict check	☐	
Intake complete	☐	
Documents received	☐	
A-number	☐	
Immigration history	☐	
EOIR, if applicable	☐	
USCIS notices	☐	
Client's goal	☐	

During

What does the client want to achieve?

Entries	Status

 NOTES

Consultation · continued

Immigration history

Criminal history

Orders

Family

Prior proceedings

Red flags



This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

Possible options

Missing information

After

STEP	DONE	DETAIL
Note to file	☐	
Engagement or declination letter	☐	
Documents requested	☐	
Follow-up	☐	
Next action	☐	

NOTES

Meeting agenda

MEETING WITH	DATE	CASE
PURPOSE OF THE MEETING		
WHAT I NEED TO VERIFY		
QUESTIONS I NEED TO ASK		
DOCUMENTS I NEED TO REVIEW		
DECISIONS THIS MEETING MUST PRODUCE		
NEXT STEPS		
RESPONSIBLE	FOLLOW-UP DATE	
NOTES		

Case strategy

 This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

CLIENT / CASE

CASE NUMBER

 GOAL

 RELEVANT FACTS

 TIMELINE (SUMMARY)

 OPEN ISSUES

 NOTES

Strategy · continued

 POSSIBLE RELIEF

 EVIDENCE

 RESEARCH NEEDED

 GOVERNMENT'S POSITION

 RISKS

 NEXT STEPS

 NOTES

 POSSIBLE BARS

 MISSING EVIDENCE

 QUESTIONS

Case timeline

CLIENT / CASE	MAIN SOURCE
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 **NOTES**

Timeline · continued

Master Calendar Hearing

 This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

CLIENT	DATE & TIME	JUDGE / ROOM
 OPEN ISSUES	 EVIDENCE / FILINGS	
 DEADLINES	 RESEARCH	
 QUESTIONS		
 PREPARATION MEETINGS		

Last-minute check

- ☐ Date, time and courtroom confirmed with the official source
- ☐ Format (in person or remote) confirmed
- ☐ Client informed and prepared
- ☐ Interpreter confirmed, if applicable
- ☐ Documents and copies ready

NOTES AFTER THE HEARING

NOTES

This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

JUDGE / ROOM

EVIDENCE

EXHIBITS

RESEARCH

 **NOTES**

Individual Hearing · continued

PREP MEETING	DATE	WITH WHOM	TOPIC

Last-minute check

- ☐ Date, time and courtroom confirmed with the official source
- ☐ Exhibits filed and proof of filing saved
- ☐ Witnesses confirmed and prepared
- ☐ Interpreter confirmed, if applicable
- ☐ Client prepared to testify
- ☐ Copies for the court and opposing counsel, per current rules

NOTES AFTER THE HEARING

☒ NEXT STEPS

NOTES

Bond Hearing

 This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

CLIENT	DATE & TIME	JUDGE / ROOM
 OPEN ISSUES	 EVIDENCE	
 WITNESSES / SPONSORS	 EXHIBITS	
 DEADLINES		
 QUESTIONS		

Last-minute check

- ☐ Location and detention center confirmed
- ☐ Date and format confirmed with the official source
- ☐ Family and sponsors informed
- ☐ Documents ready

 NOTES AFTER THE HEARING

 NOTES

INTERVIEW PREPARATION

USCIS interview

CLIENT	DATE & TIME	OFFICE
Checklist ☐ Documents requested in the notice ☐ Valid ID ☐ Story reviewed with the client ☐ Preparation session held ☐ Originals ☐ Notices (appointment, receipts) ☐ Inconsistencies identified ☐ Logistics: transportation, timing, interpreter if applicable  INCONSISTENCIES OR POINTS TO CLARIFY  PREPARATION: TOPICS WE REVIEWED  NOTES AFTER THE INTERVIEW ☒ FOLLOW-UP  NOTES		

QUALITY CONTROL

Before you file

CASE	DOCUMENT / FILING		REVIEWED BY
ITEM	OK	COMMENT	
Name	☐		
Date of birth	☐		
A-number	☐		
Address	☐		
Signatures	☐		
Current form edition	☐		
Fee (verified with the official source)	☐		
Supporting evidence	☐		
Translations and certifications	☐		
Dates	☐		
Consistency across documents	☐		
Prior filings	☐		
Cover letter	☐		
Pagination	☐		
Complete copy saved	☐		
Proof of delivery	☐		
Follow-up on the calendar	☐		
 NOTES			

QUALITY CONTROL

EOIR filings

 This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

Before filing with the Immigration Court or the BIA, check each item against the current Practice Manual and the official instructions. This list does not replace those rules.

ITEM	OK	COMMENT
Name and A-number on every document	☐	
Correct court, judge or BIA	☐	
Document type and cover page per current rules	☐	
Format, pagination and tabs per the Practice Manual	☐	
Certified translations	☐	
Exhibits with an index	☐	
Representative's signature	☐	
Current representation form in the file	☐	
Proof of service on DHS	☐	
Correct filing method	☐	
Deadline verified by two people	☐	
Proof of filing saved	☐	
Next date on the calendar	☐	

 NOTES

Every document, two sets of eyes

No document goes out with only one review. Each person signs what they reviewed.

ROLE	NAME	DATE	SIGNATURE
Prepared by			
Reviewed by			
Final review			

ITEM	PREPARED	REVIEWED	FINAL
Names	☐	☐	☐
A-number	☐	☐	☐
Dates	☐	☐	☐
Addresses	☐	☐	☐
Facts	☐	☐	☐
Forms	☐	☐	☐
Signatures	☐	☐	☐
Fees	☐	☐	☐
Evidence	☐	☐	☐
Translations	☐	☐	☐
Citations	☐	☐	☐
Deadline	☐	☐	☐
Filing method	☐	☐	☐
Proof	☐	☐	☐

📌 NOTES

Always verify the applicable rule. This sheet does not calculate deadlines: it documents how each one was calculated, under which rule and who verified it.

FIELD	ENTRY
Case	
Triggering event	
Date of event	
Date received	
Possible applicable rule	
Source consulted (and date)	
Calculation	
Weekend / holiday	
Final date	
Verified by (second person)	
Entered on calendar by	
Reminders created	
Notes or questions that were escalated	

Communication log

If it is not documented, it will be hard to prove it happened.

CLIENT / CASE

DATE / TIME	CHANNEL	PARTICIPANTS	SUBJECT AND INFORMATION SHARED	DECISION / NEXT STEP	RESP.
-------------	---------	--------------	--------------------------------	----------------------	-------

📝 NOTES

Communications · continued

[illegible]

What I am waiting for

[illegible]

Closing checklist

CLIENT / CASE

CLOSING DATE

STEP

DONE

DETAIL

Outcome documented

☐

Final communication to client

☐

Original documents returned

☐

Outstanding balance reviewed

☐

Deadlines and next steps explained

☐

Copy retained per policy

☐

Closing letter sent

☐

Case management system updated

☐

File archived

☐

 CLOSING NOTES

 WHAT THIS CASE TAUGHT ME

 NOTES



MY PRACTICE





How to use this section

This is where you design how your office works: the everyday ethics checks, the processes that cannot depend on memory, the way you supervise and what you learn from your mistakes.

Everyday ethics

- Ethics check
- Confidentiality check
- Unauthorized practice of law
- Client expectations
- Difficult conversations
- Email and WhatsApp before sending

Office systems

- Calendar system
- File naming
- File rules
- Procedures and index
- Client experience map
- Tools and renewals

Team

- Delegation log
- Delegate / automate / eliminate
- One-on-one meeting
- Questions for my team

Learning along the way

- Mistakes and lessons
- What I must not do again
- Lessons that cost me
- What works
- Decision log
- Time audit and my numbers

Delegating does not remove the duty to supervise.



Before you act, ask yourself

Use this list when a situation gives you pause. If any answer is “I don't know,” stop and consult before moving on.

QUESTION	YES	NO / UNSURE	WHAT I WILL DO
Who is my client?	☐	☐	
What is the scope of my representation?	☐	☐	
Am I competent to handle this?	☐	☐	
Is there a conflict?	☐	☐	
Am I protecting confidentiality?	☐	☐	
Am I communicating clearly?	☐	☐	
Am I supervising adequately?	☐	☐	
Am I documenting?	☐	☐	
Am I setting reasonable expectations?	☐	☐	
Is there a deadline?	☐	☐	
Do I need to do research?	☐	☐	
Do I need to ask for help?	☐	☐	

The situation I am evaluating

 NOTES

Confidentiality risks

Confidentiality is lost in everyday moments. Review each risk and set your rule.

RISK	CONTROLLED	MY RULE / ACTION
Email	☐	
WhatsApp	☐	
Text messages	☐	
Front desk	☐	
Screens	☐	
Shared folders	☐	
AI	☐	
Printing	☐	
Remote work	☐	
Public places	☐	
Client's relatives	☐	
Interpreters	☐	
Third parties	☐	

 NOTES

Information is not advice

This page is educational and especially important for professionals who are not attorneys. The rules on the unauthorized practice of law **vary by state, role and accreditation**. Always confirm the rules that apply to you.

ACTIVITY	WHAT IT IS, IN GENERAL	EXAMPLE
Administrative assistance		
Document preparation		
General legal information		
Legal advice		
Legal strategy		

Practical rule for the team: if the answer depends on a specific person's facts, it is no longer general information. Refer the question to the authorized person.

Fill in the columns with the definitions and examples your supervisor or your jurisdiction confirms. Do not make universal statements about any state's law.

 NOTES

My role and my limits

MY ROLE	MY AUTHORIZATION OR ACCREDITATION	WHO SUPERVISES ME
✓ WHAT I DO IN MY ROLE		
⚠ WHAT I DO NOT DO AND ALWAYS REFER		
👤 COMMON SITUATIONS WHERE I AM ASKED FOR AN OPINION		
✍ MY REFERRAL PHRASE		
🔗 WHOM I REFER TO AND THROUGH WHICH CHANNEL		
✍ NOTES		

EXPECTATIONS

Client expectations

CLIENT / CASE

DATE

 WHAT DOES THE CLIENT EXPECT?

 WHAT DID THEY ACTUALLY HIRE US FOR?

 WHAT DID I EXPLAIN?

 WHAT IS NOT INCLUDED?

 WHAT DEPENDS ON AN AGENCY OR COURT?

 WHAT CAN I NOT PROMISE?

 WHAT MUST I DOCUMENT?

 NOTES

DIFFICULT CONVERSATIONS

Difficult conversations

Choose the type of conversation and prepare it in writing before you have it.

- ☐ Delivering bad news
- ☐ Explaining delays
- ☐ Requesting documents
- ☐ Explaining limits
- ☐ Collections
- ☐ Mistakes
- ☐ Unrealistic expectations
- ☐ Declining representation
- ☐ Ending the professional relationship

 GOAL OF THE CONVERSATION

 FACTS

☒ **WHAT I NEED TO COMMUNICATE**

 WHAT I WILL NOT PROMISE

 QUESTIONS I EXPECT

 WHAT I WILL DOCUMENT AFTERWARD

 NOTES

DIFFICULT CONVERSATIONS

Preparing another conversation

☐ Bad news

☐ Limits

☐ Expectations

☐ Delays

☐ Collections

☐ Declining

☐ Documents

☐ Mistakes

☐ Ending relationship

 GOAL OF THE CONVERSATION

 FACTS

☒ **WHAT I NEED TO COMMUNICATE**

 WHAT I WILL NOT PROMISE

 QUESTIONS I EXPECT

 WHAT I WILL DOCUMENT AFTERWARD

 NOTES

Email and WhatsApp

- ☐ Correct recipient
- ☐ Correct attachment
- ☐ Correct client
- ☐ Correct A-number
- ☐ Confidential information reviewed
- ☐ Tone
- ☐ Deadline mentioned
- ☐ Clear instructions
- ☐ Next step
- ☐ Should I document it?

- ☐ Is it the right client?
- ☐ Is it the right document?
- ☐ Is there information about someone else?
- ☐ Am I giving information or advice?
- ☐ Should I document this conversation in the file?

If the answer is legal advice, the conversation belongs to the authorized person.

🔗 MY MESSAGING RULES (HOURS, OFFICIAL CHANNELS, WHAT IS NEVER SENT BY CHAT)

 NOTES

Design your calendar system

What goes on the calendar?

Who enters it?

Who verifies it?

How many reminders?

☐ 30 days ☐ 14 days ☐ 7 days ☐ 2 days ☐ Other: _____

What happens when a new notice arrives?

What happens when a date changes?

How do we confirm it was updated?

 NOTES

How we name files

There is no single correct naming convention. What matters is that the whole office uses the same one, with no exceptions.

Conceptual example: **DATE_CLIENT_DOCUMENT_VERSION**
2027-03-15_Lopez_I-130_v2

 OUR FILE NAMING RULE

 EXAMPLES FROM OUR OFFICE

 NAMES WE DO NOT USE

 HOW THE FINAL VERSION IS MARKED

 WHO CHECKS COMPLIANCE

 NOTES

What every file must contain

What information must every file contain?

Which communications must be documented?

Where do we store documents?

Who closes out tasks?

Who reviews deadlines?

When is a case considered closed?

 NOTES

PROCEDURES

Procedure (SOP)

PROCESS NAME		OWNER	REVIEW DATE
GOAL		WHEN IT STARTS	
#	STEP	DOCUMENT / TOOL	
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
QUALITY CONTROL		WHEN TO ESCALATE	
WHEN IT ENDS		WHERE IT IS DOCUMENTED	
NOTES			

Procedure · another copy

PROCESS NAME		OWNER	REVIEW DATE
 GOAL		 WHEN IT STARTS	
#	STEP	DOCUMENT / TOOL	
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
 QUALITY CONTROL		 WHEN TO ESCALATE	
 WHEN IT ENDS		 WHERE IT IS DOCUMENTED	
 NOTES			

Procedure index

[illegible]

What I delegated

Delegating does not remove the duty to supervise.

[illegible]

 NOTES

What to do with each task

List the tasks you repeat and decide what happens with each one. If a task is delegated or automated, write down the process it needs.

TASK	KEEP	DELEGATE	AUTOMATE	ELIMINATE	PROCESS NEEDED
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	
	☐	☐	☐	☐	

 NOTES

One-on-one meeting

EMPLOYEE / PARALEGAL

DATE

 WHAT IS WORKING

 WORKLOAD

 DIFFICULT CASES

 MISTAKES

 RESOURCES NEEDED

 TRAINING

 FEEDBACK

 GOALS

 FOLLOW-UP

 NOTES

One-on-one meeting

EMPLOYEE / PARALEGAL

DATE

 WHAT IS WORKING

 DIFFICULT CASES

 RESOURCES NEEDED

 FEEDBACK

 GOALS

 FOLLOW-UP

 NOTES

 WORKLOAD

 MISTAKES

 TRAINING

For the next meeting

TOPIC	PERSON	WHY	DECISION NEEDED
-------	--------	-----	-----------------

The client journey

For each stage, define who is responsible, what the client receives and where the experience can break down.

STAGE	OWNER	CLIENT GETS	COMMUNICATION DOCUMENTS	WEAK POINTS
Consultation				
Engagement				
Intake				
Preparation				
Filing				

Journey · continued

STAGE	OWNER	CLIENT GETS	COMMUNICATION DOCUMENTS	WEAK POINTS
-------	-------	-------------	-------------------------	-------------

Follow-up

Hearing /
interview

Decision

Closing

 NOTES

MISTAKES AND LESSONS

Don't hide the mistake. Learn from it.

DATE	RESPONSIBLE FOR FOLLOW-UP
------	---------------------------

 WHAT HAPPENED

 HOW IT WAS DETECTED

 IMPACT

 HOW IT WAS CORRECTED

 WHY IT HAPPENED

 WHAT PROCESS MUST CHANGE

 PROCEDURE WE MUST UPDATE

 FOLLOW-UP

 NOTES

MISTAKES AND LESSONS

Don't hide the mistake. Learn from it.

DATE

RESPONSIBLE FOR FOLLOW-UP

 WHAT HAPPENED

 HOW IT WAS DETECTED

 IMPACT

 HOW IT WAS CORRECTED

 WHY IT HAPPENED

 WHAT PROCESS MUST CHANGE

 PROCEDURE WE MUST UPDATE

 FOLLOW-UP

 NOTES



What I must not do again

What did I do?

What happened?

What was the consequence?

What did I learn?

What will I do differently?

Do I need to change a process?

My new rule

 NOTES



What I must not do again

What did I do?

What happened?

What was the consequence?

What did I learn?

What will I do differently?

Do I need to change a process?

My new rule

 NOTES



What I must not do again

What did I do?

What happened?

What was the consequence?

What did I learn?

What will I do differently?

Do I need to change a process?

My new rule

 NOTES

LESSONS LEARNED

Lessons that cost me time, money or energy

What happened?

What did it cost me?

What did I learn?

How will I avoid repeating it?

What happened?

What did it cost me?

What did I learn?

How will I avoid repeating it?

 NOTES

This worked. Repeat it.

What I did

What I did

Why it worked

Why it worked

Decision log

For professional and business learning. It does not replace the legal notes each file requires.

 DECISION

 CONTEXT

 OPTIONS

 INFORMATION AVAILABLE

 RISKS

 PEOPLE CONSULTED

 DECISION MADE AND WHY

 OUTCOME

 WOULD I MAKE THE SAME DECISION AGAIN?

 NOTES

Decision log

For professional and business learning. It does not replace the legal notes each file requires.

 DECISION

 CONTEXT

 OPTIONS

 INFORMATION AVAILABLE

 RISKS

 PEOPLE CONSULTED

 DECISION MADE AND WHY

 OUTCOME

 WOULD I MAKE THE SAME DECISION AGAIN?

 NOTES

TIME AUDIT

Where did my time go?

Track a typical week. Write down approximate hours by category.

CATEGORY	M	T	W	T	F	TOTAL
Client work						
Court						
USCIS						
Research						
Meetings						
Email						
Calls						
Administration						
Supervision						
Marketing						
Training						
Other						

What did I do that someone else could have done?

NOTES

REFERRALS

Where did my clients come from?

Understanding where your clients come from is also knowing your social capital.

CLIENT / MATTER	REFERRAL SOURCE	DATE	HIRED?	THANKS SENT	NOTES
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	
			☐	☐	

My numbers 2027

INDICATOR	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN
-----------	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

New cases

Closed cases

Active cases

Receivables

Revenue

Expenses

Training investment

Referral sources

What these numbers tell me

 **NOTES**

My numbers 2027 · July to December

INDICATOR	JUL	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
-----------	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Consultations

New cases

Closed cases

Active cases

Receivables

Revenue

Expenses

Training investment

Referral sources

What these numbers tell me

 NOTES

My tools

TOOL	USED FOR	RESP.	COST	RENEWAL	DATA & SECURITY	NEED IT?
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐

Subscriptions and renewals

Software • Bar • Professional association • Research • CLE • Insurance • Domain • Other

SUBSCRIPTION	TYPE	RENEWAL DATE	COST	AUTO-RENEW	REVIEW / CANCEL
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐
					☐

KEY DATES

Important professional dates

TYPE	DETAIL	DUE DATE	REMINDER
License or bar renewal			
CLE deadline			
Professional liability insurance			
Registrations			
Organization renewals			
Professional memberships			
Contracts			
Other			
Other			
Other			

Verify each date with the relevant entity.

 NOTES

What I want for my practice

Type: software, book, course, membership, equipment, service.

PROJECT	DUE DATE	STATUS
---------	----------	--------

PURPOSE

 EXPECTED RESULT

#	STEP	OWNER	DATE
---	------	-------	------

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

 PEOPLE

RESOURCES

 BUDGET

 NEXT ACTION

 NOTES

Project

PROJECT	DUE DATE	STATUS
---------	----------	--------

 PURPOSE	 EXPECTED RESULT
--	---

#	STEP	OWNER	DATE
---	------	-------	------

1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			

 PEOPLE	 RESOURCES
---	---

 BUDGET	 NEXT ACTION
---	---

 NOTES	
--	--



MY KNOWLEDGE



How to use this section

This section is your system for learning in an organized way: where the law you apply comes from, how to verify a source, which cases you are following, what you researched and what you want to study. Nothing here replaces the official source: it helps you get there and keep a record of what you reviewed.

Understand the system

- Where does immigration law come from?
- Who does what?
- Immigration system map
- Source check

Research and remember

- My “I don’t know” list
- Things I keep looking up
- Idea bank
- I read this · I heard this

Case law

- Case brief
- BIA case of the month (12)
- Research log
- My professional library

Training and AI

- Courses and course notes
- Books, podcasts and videos
- Artificial intelligence with judgment
- Prompt library

Don’t cite what you haven’t read.



Where does immigration law come from?



SOURCE	WHAT IT GENERALLY CONTAINS
--------	----------------------------

How I read a source

QUESTION

MY ANSWER

What type of source is it?

Who issued it?

Is it binding or only guidance?

Does it apply in my jurisdiction?

Is it in effect today?

Was it amended, revoked or challenged?

Where is the official version?

When did I verify it?

🔍 SOURCES I CONSULT MOST OFTEN AND WHERE I FIND THEM

📝 NOTES

Who does what?

Verify current information. Verify current information at the official source before using it. Agency functions, structures and names can change.

ENTITY	WHAT IT GENERALLY DOES	OFFICIAL SOURCE I CHECKED
USCIS	Decides applications and petitions for immigration benefits.	
EOIR	Department of Justice agency that administers the immigration courts and the BIA.	
Immigration courts	Immigration judges who conduct removal proceedings and decide certain applications for relief.	
BIA	Board of Immigration Appeals: the highest administrative appellate body for immigration matters.	
DHS	Department of Homeland Security; includes USCIS, ICE and CBP, among others.	
ICE	Enforces immigration laws in the interior of the country, including detention.	
OPLA	Attorneys who represent the government (DHS) before the immigration courts.	
CBP	Inspection at ports of entry and border control.	
DOS	Department of State: embassies and consulates that process visas.	
Federal courts	Review certain immigration decisions depending on the path and jurisdiction.	

 NOTES

How the pieces connect

Benefits

Application or petition → USCIS → Decision → Possible avenues of review (verify which applies)

Application or petition → USCIS → Decision → Possible avenues of review (verify which applies)

Approved petition → National Visa Center → Embassy or consulate (DOS) → Visa → Inspection at the port of entry (CBP)

Notice to Appear issued by DHS → Immigration court (EOIR) → BIA → Federal court of appeals

ICE detention → Custody review or bond hearing, if applicable → Court proceedings

 **NOTES**

My map: the paths I use most

Draw or describe the paths that come up most often in your practice, with the official sources you consult at each step.

 PATH 1

 PATH 2

 PATH 3

 NOTES

Offices and forums I work with

OFFICE / COURT	ADDRESS OR CHANNEL	CONTACT OR PORTAL	NOTES	VERIFIED
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

SOURCE CHECK

Before using a source

SOURCE	TYPE	CURRENT?	VERIFIED ON	BY
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		
		☐		

- ☐ I read the full source, not just a summary
- ☐ I confirmed it is the official, current version
- ☐ I checked whether it was amended or revoked
- ☐ I confirmed it applies in my jurisdiction
- ☐ I noted the exact citation and the date I verified it
- ☐ Someone else reviewed the citation, if it goes into a filing

 NOTES

A citation you did not verify is a risk to your client, your credibility and your license.

- ## MY OFFICE PROTOCOL FOR VERIFYING CITATIONS

 NOTES

What I need to research

Saying "I don't know" in time is a form of competence. Write down the question, research it and record the answer with its source.

DATE	QUESTION	WHERE I'LL LOOK	ANSWER AND SOURCE	DONE
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

Topics I check again and again

Continued

[illegible]



I READ THIS

I want to remember it

 TITLE AND AUTHOR OR SOURCE

 DATE

 MAIN IDEA

 WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

 HOW I WILL APPLY IT

 TITLE AND AUTHOR OR SOURCE

 DATE

 MAIN IDEA

 WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

 HOW I WILL APPLY IT

 NOTES

I want to remember it · continued

 TITLE AND AUTHOR OR SOURCE

 DATE

 MAIN IDEA

 WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

 HOW I WILL APPLY IT

 TITLE AND AUTHOR OR SOURCE

 DATE

 MAIN IDEA

 WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

 HOW I WILL APPLY IT

 NOTES

I HEARD THIS

I want to remember it

 SPEAKER, COURSE OR EPISODE

 DATE

 MAIN IDEA

 WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

 HOW I WILL APPLY IT

 SPEAKER, COURSE OR EPISODE

 DATE

 MAIN IDEA

 WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER

 HOW I WILL APPLY IT

 NOTES

CASE LAW

Case brief



This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	FORUM AND DATE

OFFICIAL SOURCE CONSULTED	DATE VERIFIED	STILL GOOD LAW?

 RELEVANT FACTS

 LEGAL QUESTION

 WHAT WAS DECIDED

 REASONING

 LIMITS: WHAT THIS CASE DOES NOT DECIDE

 HOW IT AFFECTS MY PRACTICE

 NOTES

Case brief · another copy

 This tool is for use by an attorney or authorized representative, or under their supervision. Anyone without authorization gathers information and does not give legal advice.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	FORUM AND DATE

OFFICIAL SOURCE CONSULTED	DATE VERIFIED	STILL GOOD LAW?

 **RELEVANT FACTS**

 **LEGAL QUESTION**

 **WHAT WAS DECIDED**

 **REASONING**

 **LIMITS: WHAT THIS CASE DOES NOT DECIDE**

 **HOW IT AFFECTS MY PRACTICE**

 **NOTES**

January 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
 TOPIC	 VERIFIED ON	
 THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
 QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
 WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
 WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
 WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
 WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	 EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
 NOTES		

February 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
TOPIC	VERIFIED ON	
THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	EPISODE OR NOTE FROM "LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ"	
NOTES		

March 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
-----------	-------------------	---------------

 TOPIC	 VERIFIED ON
--	---

 THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES	

 QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED	

 WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED	

 WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE	

 WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH	
---	--

 WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	 EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”

 NOTES	

April 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
 TOPIC	 VERIFIED ON	
 THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
 QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
 WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
 WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
 WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
 WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	 EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
 NOTES		

May 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
 TOPIC	 VERIFIED ON	
 THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
 QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
 WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
 WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
 WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
 WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	 EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
 NOTES		

June 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
TOPIC THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION NOTES	VERIFIED ON EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	

July 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
 TOPIC	 VERIFIED ON	
 THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
 QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
 WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
 WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
 WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
 WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	 EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
 NOTES		

August 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
 TOPIC	 VERIFIED ON	
 THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
 QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
 WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
 WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
 WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
 WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	 EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
 NOTES		

BIA CASE OF THE MONTH

September 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
 TOPIC	 VERIFIED ON	
 THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
 QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
 WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
 WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
 WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
 WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	 EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
 NOTES		

October 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
TOPIC	VERIFIED ON	
THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
NOTES		

BIA CASE OF THE MONTH

November 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
 TOPIC	 VERIFIED ON	
 THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
 QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
 WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
 WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
 WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
 WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	 EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
 NOTES		

December 2027

Choose a recent or relevant precedent decision. Write down the exact citation only after reading it at the official source.

CASE NAME	OFFICIAL CITATION	DECISION DATE
TOPIC	VERIFIED ON	
THE FACTS IN A FEW LINES		
QUESTION THE BOARD RESOLVED		
WHAT THE BOARD DECIDED		
WHAT CHANGES IN MY PRACTICE		
WHO I WILL SHARE IT WITH		
WHERE I READ THE OFFICIAL DECISION	EPISODE OR NOTE FROM “LA JUNTA DECIDIÓ”	
NOTES		

What I researched

Continued

DATE	QUESTION / CASE	SOURCES CONSULTED	FINDING	TIME
------	-----------------	-------------------	---------	------

Where everything is

Write down the resource, where you find it and when you confirmed it is the current version. Don't save links you haven't verified.

1. Immigration and Nationality Act (INA)

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

2. Regulations (8 CFR and others)

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

3. BIA and Attorney General precedent decisions

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

4. Case law of my circuit

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

Continued

5. Supreme Court

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

6. Immigration Court and BIA Practice Manuals

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

7. USCIS Policy Manual

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

8. Forms and instructions

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

 NOTES

Continued

9. Foreign Affairs Manual and consular resources

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

10. Agency memoranda and guidance

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

11. Country conditions

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

12. Treatises and reference books

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

 NOTES

Continued

13. Journals, newsletters and alerts

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

14. Professional organizations

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

15. Continuing legal education

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

 NOTES

Continued

16. Ethics and rules of professional conduct

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

17. Asylum and protection

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

18. Detention and bond

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

📌 NOTES

Continued

19. Technology tools

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

20. Models and templates

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

21. Client and community resources

RESOURCE	WHERE I FIND IT	VERIFIED

 NOTES

Courses I want to take

Before buying another course



A course is worth it when it solves a concrete need and you have time to apply it.

QUESTION	YES	NO	NOTE
What concrete problem will it help me solve?	☐	☐	
Do I already have a pending course on the same topic?	☐	☐	
Do I know the instructor's experience?	☐	☐	
Is the content up to date?	☐	☐	
Do I have time on my calendar to take it?	☐	☐	
How will I apply it in the next four weeks?	☐	☐	
Does it count toward my CLE credits?	☐	☐	
Does it fit my training budget?	☐	☐	

MY DECISION AND WHY

NOTES

[illegible]

COURSE _____ INSTRUCTOR _____ DATE _____

✍ MAIN IDEAS

💡 WHAT I WILL APPLY

WHAT I NEED TO VERIFY

 NEXT STEP

 NOTES

Books I want to read

TITLE	AUTHOR	WHY	STARTED	FINISHED
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐
			☐	☐

Reading notes

BOOK	AUTHOR	DATES
------	--------	-------

 IDEAS I WANT TO REMEMBER

 WHAT I WILL CHANGE IN MY PRACTICE

 QUOTE OR PAGE TO COME BACK TO

 NOTES

Reading notes

BOOK

AUTHOR

DATES

 IDEAS I WANT TO REMEMBER

 WHAT I WILL CHANGE IN MY PRACTICE

 QUOTE OR PAGE TO COME BACK TO

 NOTES

Podcasts and videos

DATE	TITLE OR EPISODE	SOURCE	MAIN IDEA	APPLY
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

AI for immigration professionals



AI can save you time. Professional responsibility remains yours.

Appropriate uses

- Organizing schedules, tasks, and daily priorities
- Drafting emails and internal communications
- Summarizing public documents and official guidance
- Simplifying text into plain language, with professional review
- Creating internal procedures and checklists
- Designing trainings and exercises with fictional cases
- Practicing legal English or Spanish and improving writing
- Planning educational content and ethical marketing

Risks

- Confidentiality: client data exposed in unapproved tools
- Invented citations: cases, rules, or sources that do not exist
- Outdated information: forms, fees, or policies that have changed
- Bias: answers that reproduce stereotypes or unequal treatment
- Overreliance: accepting the output without critical review
- Unauthorized practice: unauthorized staff giving legal advice
- Terms of service: tools that retain or reuse your data
- Supervision: delegating to AI what requires professional judgment

Review your jurisdiction's rules, your office policies and each tool's terms of service. No tool authorizes anyone who is not authorized to give legal advice.

NOTES

- ## ✍ TOOLS APPROVED IN MY OFFICE

 NOTES

ELEMENT	GUIDING QUESTION	EXAMPLE
Role	From what experience or perspective should the AI respond?	<i>Act as the operations coordinator of an immigration office.</i>
Context	What general situation does it need to know, without confidential data?	<i>We are preparing a talk for families at a community center.</i>
Task	What specific action do you want it to perform?	<i>Summarize this public text in five key points.</i>
Format	How do you want to receive the result?	<i>A table with three columns: task, owner, and deadline.</i>
Limits	What should the AI not do or include?	<i>Do not give individual advice or invent citations or sources.</i>
Verification	What should it flag for a professional to review?	<i>Mark with [VERIFY] every fact that must be confirmed in official sources.</i>

Prompts by category

Copy the structure, replace what is in brackets and always review the result. Copy-ready versions will be available in the digital library.

Organizing your day

Prioritize my day. Act as a planning assistant. Here is my to-do list for today: [task list with no client data]. I have [number] hours available and these fixed appointments: [times]. Rank the tasks by urgency and importance, suggest realistic time blocks with breaks, and point out what I could delegate or postpone.

Five-minute end-of-day wrap-up. Help me close out my day. Today I completed: [completed tasks]. Still pending: [pending tasks]. Write a brief progress summary, a list of the top three priorities for tomorrow, and one reflection question about what took up the most time. Use bullet points and no more than 120 words.

Professional emails

Friendly follow-up email. Draft a professional email to [recipient: colleague, agency, vendor] following up on [general matter, no confidential data]. Friendly, direct tone. Include a subject line, greeting, one paragraph with the specific request, the deadline [date], and a courteous closing. 150 words maximum. I will review it before sending.

Reply firmly and courteously. I need to reply to an email about [situation: complaint, out-of-scope request, date change]. My position is [position]. Draft two versions of the reply, one more formal and one warmer, that keep clear boundaries without sounding defensive. Do not include commitments or deadlines I have not mentioned.

Clear client communication

Clear appointment reminder. Draft a message reminding a client of their appointment on [date and time] at [location or format]. List the general documents to bring: [list]. Use plain language at a sixth-grade reading level, a respectful tone, and short sentences. Do not include names or case numbers; I will add them when I review.

Explain where a matter stands. Turn this technical explanation into a plain-language draft for a client: [anonymized explanation of the general status of the matter]. Avoid jargon, define any necessary terms, and close by inviting them to contact the office. The attorney or accredited representative will review it before it goes out; flag any sentence that sounds like a promise of results.

NOTES

Summarize official guidance. Summarize this public text I am pasting: [text of a USCIS or EOIR guide, alert, or policy]. Give the main idea in two sentences, the key changes in bullet points, any effective dates mentioned, and who is affected in general terms. This is a draft for attorney review; note which points must be verified against the official source.

Compare old and new versions. Compare these two versions of a public document. Old version: [text]. New version: [text]. Make a table with three columns: section, what changed, and possible operational impact for the office. Do not interpret beyond the text. This is a draft for professional review; mark with [VERIFY] anything that must be confirmed in the official source.

Research question map. I am starting general research on [general legal topic, no client facts]. Help me frame research questions, search terms in English and Spanish, and the types of primary sources I should consult. Do not cite specific cases or rules: just tell me where to look. A licensed attorney will validate the entire result.

Starter glossary for a topic. Prepare an introductory glossary of [number] terms on [general immigration topic]. For each term include a simple definition in English, the Spanish equivalent, and a note on possible confusion. This is study material, not legal advice. Flag which definitions must be confirmed in official sources because they may have changed.

Meeting preparation

Team meeting agenda. Prepare an agenda for a [length]-minute team meeting on [topics]. Participants: [roles]. Include the meeting goal, items with allotted time, who presents each item, and space for agreements. End with three questions that help us close with concrete decisions. Present everything in table format.

Questions for an outside meeting. I am meeting with [type of contact: community organization, vendor, colleague] to discuss [purpose]. Suggest ten questions ordered from general to specific, two possible objections with ideas for responding, and a list of what I should bring. Do not include confidential office or client information.

Internal procedures

Turn steps into an SOP. Turn these notes into a standard internal procedure: [steps as we do them today]. Structure: purpose, scope, responsible people, materials, numbered steps, checkpoints, and what to do if something goes wrong. Use plain language and imperative verbs. Mark with [CONFIRM] any ambiguous or incomplete step so the team can review it.

Find gaps in a procedure. Review this internal procedure: [procedure text]. Identify missing steps, unclear responsibilities, confidentiality risks, and points that need review by an attorney or accredited representative. Give your observations in a table with finding, risk, and suggestion. Do not change legal requirements; just flag them for verification in official sources.

Team training

Fifteen-minute micro-lesson. Design a 15-minute micro-lesson for [role: front desk, paralegals, assistants] on [operational topic]. Include a goal, a brief explanation, an example with fictional facts, a hands-on activity, and three review questions with answers. If the topic touches on legal content, note what an attorney must validate before it is taught.

Fictional practice scenarios. Create [number] fictional scenarios to practice [skill: phone calls, receiving documents, handling upset clients]. Each scenario should include the situation, the main challenge, and a model response. Use made-up names and details. Model responses must not include eligibility decisions or legal advice.

 NOTES

Quality control

Review an internal document. Review this anonymized draft: [text]. Point out spelling errors, inconsistencies in names, dates, or figures, ambiguous sentences, and incomplete sections. Give a numbered list with location, problem, and suggestion. Do not change the legal content; flag for attorney review any substantive point that seems doubtful or must be verified.

Pre-send checklist. Create a quality control checklist to review [type of deliverable: document package, correspondence, filing] before it leaves the office. Group the items under form, content, confidentiality, and approvals, with no more than 15 items. Indicate which ones require sign-off from the attorney or accredited representative.

Translation and style

Draft translation with notes. Translate this anonymized text into [language]: [text]. Keep a [formal/neutral] register and leave official names in their original language. Then make a table of difficult terms, the option chosen, and alternatives. This is a draft: if it will be submitted to an agency, a qualified translator must review and certify it.

Polish style without changing meaning. Improve the style of this [English/Spanish] text: [text]. Goals: clarity, shorter sentences, plain language, and no unnecessary jargon or borrowed terms. Do not change the meaning or add information. Show the revised text first, then a list of the main changes with a brief reason for each.

 NOTES

Legal English and Spanish

Vocabulary in context. I am an immigration professional and want to strengthen my legal [English/Spanish]. Give me 10 terms about [area: hearings, forms, agency correspondence] with a definition, an example sentence in [English/Spanish], and its translation. At the end, add a fill-in-the-blank exercise with the answers listed separately. Flag any terms whose usage I should confirm.

Professional conversation role-play. Role-play a conversation in [English/Spanish] in which I am [my role] and you are [counterpart: agency receptionist, colleague, court staff, client] about [general situation]. Ask one question at a time, wait for my answer, and kindly correct my grammar and vocabulary. Use only fictional facts and briefly explain each correction.

Community education

General information session. Prepare an outline for a [length] community talk on [general topic]. Audience: [description]. Include objectives, key messages in plain language, common myths, and a notice that the talk does not replace an individual consultation. This is a draft for attorney review; mark the facts that must be verified in official sources.

Community FAQs. Write [number] frequently asked questions with general answers about [topic], aimed at [audience]. Use plain language and short sentences. Each answer should encourage readers to consult an attorney or accredited representative about their own situation. This is a draft for professional review; flag which statements require verification in official sources.

Social media content

Posting calendar. Create a [number]-week posting calendar for [social network] for an immigration office. Topics: [general topics]. For each post list the day, topic, format, a one-line caption idea, and an ethical call to action. Avoid promises of results, artificial urgency, and testimonials with identifiable details.

From topic to post. Turn this topic into an educational post for [social network]: [general topic]. Include an opening hook, three key points in plain language, a note that this is general information, and an invitation to schedule a consultation. Maximum [number] words. This is a draft; mark what an attorney must verify before it is posted.

 NOTES

Put an ad under the microscope. Review this promotional text: [ad text]. Identify phrases that look like guarantees of results, misleading language, improper use of terms like “notario,” and claims of specialization that may not be permitted. Suggest alternatives. This is a preliminary review: note what must be confirmed against the applicable rules of professional conduct.

Time management

Spot the time thieves. Here is how I spent my time this week: [approximate log of activities and hours]. Identify patterns, frequent interruptions, and tasks I could automate, delegate, or batch. Propose three concrete changes for next week and a simple way to measure whether they worked. Be direct and prioritize what has the greatest impact.

Plan to learn a topic. I want to learn about [professional topic] in [number] weeks, with [hours] hours per week. Design a plan with weekly goals, activities, recommended types of sources, and a way to assess my progress. Do not invent book titles, courses, or links; suggest categories of sources and I will find the specific ones.

Explain it like a mentor. Explain [general concept] to me the way an experienced mentor would. Start with an analogy, follow with the formal explanation, then an example with fictional facts, and finish with three questions to check my understanding. If the concept is legal, tell me which parts I should verify in current official sources.

Review and reflection

Guided weekly review. Walk me through a weekly review. Wins: [list]. What did not go as expected: [list]. Ask me five questions, one at a time, to identify lessons, priorities, and something I should stop doing. At the end, summarize my answers as three concrete, measurable commitments for next week.

Guided weekly review. Walk me through a weekly review. Wins: [list]. What did not go as expected: [list]. Ask me five questions, one at a time, to identify lessons, priorities, and something I should stop doing. At the end, summarize my answers as three concrete, measurable commitments for next week.

Learn from an operational error. Help me analyze an operational error without assigning blame. What happened: [anonymized description]. What the consequence was: [impact]. Apply a simple root-cause analysis, propose measures to prevent it from happening again, and draft a brief, constructive message to share the lesson with the team.

 NOTES

Featured prompts

From meeting notes to tasks

After a team meeting, to turn messy notes into agreements with owners and dates.

Role: act as the operations coordinator of an immigration office. Context: we held a team meeting on [topic]; participants were [roles]. These are my notes: [notes with no client data]. Task: pull out each agreement and turn it into an actionable task. Format: a table with task, owner, deadline, priority, and dependency; then a list of pending decisions. Limits: do not invent owners or dates; if they are missing, write [TO BE ASSIGNED]. Do not include confidential information. Verification: at the end, list the ambiguous notes that need confirmation from the team.

Verify: That every task has a real owner and that nothing important from the notes was left out.

Explain a process to the community

For talks, flyers, or posts that explain a general process without getting into individual cases.

Role: act as a community educator working with an immigration office. Context: I am preparing material for [audience] about [general process]; many people have questions and little familiarity with legal terms. Task: explain in plain language what the process involves, its general stages, and the most common mistakes. Format: a brief introduction, numbered steps, a myths-and-facts section, and a closing. Limits: do not give individual advice, assess eligibility, or promise results; include a note that this is general information. Verification: this is a draft for attorney review; mark with [VERIFY] every fact, deadline, or cost that must be confirmed in official sources.

Verify: Deadlines, fees, and requirements against the current official source, and that there are no implied promises.

Internal checklist from official instructions

When an agency publishes instructions and the team needs a practical checklist.

Role: act as a quality control specialist at an immigration office. Context: I am pasting these official instructions verbatim: [text of USCIS or EOIR instructions, with the edition date]. Task: turn them into an internal checklist for the team. Format: checkboxes grouped by stage, with the section of the instructions each item comes from in parentheses. Limits: use only the text provided; do not add requirements from memory or interpret gray areas. Verification: at the end, list the questions, contradictions, or ambiguous points an attorney or accredited representative must resolve.

Verify: That every item actually appears in the instructions and that the edition is current.

NOTES

To strengthen your professional English or Spanish with a short, realistic plan tailored to your daily practice.

Verify: That the plan is realistic for your schedule and that the technical terms are correct.

Before sending a sensitive email, to improve tone and clarity and protect confidentiality.

Verify: Recipients, attachments, and that no identifying details remain before you send.

 NAME	 WHAT I USE IT FOR
 PROMPT	

 NAME	 WHAT I USE IT FOR
 PROMPT	

 NAME	 WHAT I USE IT FOR
 PROMPT	

The ones that work for me

 NAME

 WHAT I USE IT FOR

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 NOTES



IMMIGRATION VOCABULARY





How to use this section

A bilingual English–Spanish glossary for professionals who serve Spanish-speaking clients. Here you will find the terms, verbs, phrases and acronyms that come up most often in immigration practice. Each term appears in English with its Spanish equivalent, a short definition and an example of use in context.

Before you start

- The definitions are general and educational. The exact meaning depends on the statute, the regulation and the forum.
- The example phrases are language structures, not models to file without review by an attorney or authorized representative.
- In this planner, **respondent** is rendered in Spanish as **demandado**: the person in removal proceedings.
- Program and agency names can change. Always verify current terminology at the official source.
- The complete glossary, with more terms, will be available in the digital library.

📖 TERMS I WANT TO MASTER THIS YEAR

✍️ HOW I WILL PRACTICE



A

Accredited representative **representante acreditado**

Non-attorney authorized by DOJ to represent clients of a recognized organization.

An accredited representative may appear before the court on behalf of clients.

Acquiescence **aquiescencia**

A public official's awareness of torture and failure to intervene to prevent it.

The evidence shows police acquiescence to the threats.

Acquisition of citizenship **adquisición de la ciudadanía**

Citizenship obtained at birth abroad through a U.S. citizen parent.

He may have acquired citizenship at birth through his mother.

Adjudication **adjudicación**

The agency's process of reviewing and deciding an application or petition.

Adjudication of the application may take several months.

Adjustment of status **ajuste de estatus**

Process of obtaining permanent residence without leaving the United States.

She is eligible to apply for adjustment of status inside the country.

Administrative closure **cierre administrativo**

Temporary removal of a case from the judge's active calendar without a decision on the merits.

The judge granted administrative closure while the visa petition remained pending.

Administrative processing **trámite administrativo adicional**

Additional review of a visa application after the interview, before a final decision.

The visa case remains in administrative processing after the interview.

Admissibility **admisibilidad**

Meeting the legal requirements to be admitted to the United States.

The consular officer reviews admissibility during the interview.

Admission **admisión**

Lawful entry after inspection and authorization by an immigration officer.

Her admission was recorded when she entered with a visitor visa.

Advance parole **permiso de viaje anticipado**

Document allowing certain applicants to travel abroad and seek to return.

Do not travel abroad until the advance parole document is approved.

Affidavit **declaración jurada**

Written statement signed under oath before an authorized official.

The neighbor signed an affidavit describing the couple's daily life.

Affidavit of support **declaración de patrocinio económico**

Sponsor's legal commitment to financially support the immigrant so they do not rely on public benefits.

The petitioner signed the affidavit of support and attached tax returns.

A – B

Affirmative asylum **asilo afirmativo**

Asylum application filed with USCIS by someone not in removal proceedings.

She filed for affirmative asylum and attended an interview.

Alternatives to detention **alternativas a la detención**

Supervision programs, such as check-ins or electronic monitoring, used instead of physical detention.

The client was released into an alternatives to detention program.

Apostille **apostilla**

Certification validating a public document for use in another Hague Convention country.

The birth certificate needs an apostille before it is used abroad.

Appeal **apelación**

Request asking a higher body to review and change an unfavorable decision.

The respondent filed an appeal with the Board.

Appellant **apelante**

The party who files an appeal against a decision.

The appellant argues that the judge misapplied the law.

Asylee **asilado**

A person who has been granted asylum in the United States.

As an asylee, he may petition for his spouse and children.

Asylum officer **oficial de asilo**

USCIS officer who interviews applicants and decides asylum cases and fear screenings.

The asylum officer asked detailed questions about the incident.

Attorney of record **abogado registrado**

Attorney formally listed as a party's representative in the case.

Only the attorney of record should receive notices from the court.

Authentication **autenticación**

Confirming that a document is genuine and comes from its stated source.

The government questioned the authentication of the police report.

Background check **verificación de antecedentes**

Government security and records check of the applicant.

The case is on hold pending a background check.

Beneficiary **beneficiario**

The person on whose behalf an immigration petition is filed.

The beneficiary lives abroad with her two children.

Biometrics appointment **cita de biometría**

Appointment to take the applicant's fingerprints, photograph, and signature.

The client must bring the appointment notice to the biometrics appointment.

B – C

Bona fide marriage **matrimonio de buena fe**

A genuine marriage entered to build a life together, not just for immigration benefits.

Joint bank statements help prove a bona fide marriage.

Bond hearing **audiencia de fianza**

Hearing where the judge decides whether a detained person may be released on bond.

The family brought letters of support to the bond hearing.

Bond obligor **garante de la fianza**

Person who posts the bond and guarantees the released person meets their obligations.

The bond obligor must keep a current address on file.

Brief **escrito de argumentos**

Written document setting out a party's legal and factual arguments.

Counsel requested additional time to file the brief.

Burden of proof **carga de la prueba**

A party's obligation to prove the facts it claims.

The applicant bears the burden of proof for eligibility.

Cancellation of removal **cancelación de deportación**

Discretionary relief that stops removal and may grant permanent residence if requirements are met.

The respondent applied for cancellation of removal at the master calendar hearing.

Certificate of naturalization **certificado de naturalización**

Document proving that a person became a citizen through naturalization.

Keep the certificate of naturalization in a safe place.

Certified translation **traducción certificada**

Translation accompanied by the translator's signed certification of competence and accuracy.

Every foreign-language document requires a certified translation.

Change of venue **cambio de sede**

Transfer of a case to another immigration court, usually after a change of address.

Counsel filed a motion for a change of venue after the client moved.

Charge of removability **cargo de deportabilidad**

Legal ground the government invokes to argue a person can be removed.

The respondent denied the charge of removability through counsel.

Circuit court **tribunal de circuito**

Federal court of appeals that reviews final BIA decisions within its region.

The case is now pending before the circuit court.

Civics test **examen de educación cívica**

Oral test on U.S. history and government given at the naturalization interview.

She studied every week to pass the civics test.

C

Civil surgeon **médico autorizado**

Physician designated by USCIS to perform the immigration medical exam in the United States.

Schedule the medical exam with a designated civil surgeon.

Conditional permanent resident **residente permanente condicional**

Resident with a temporary card, through recent marriage or investment, who must apply to remove conditions.

As a conditional permanent resident, she must file to remove conditions.

Confidentiality **confidencialidad**

Duty to protect client information obtained during the representation.

Confidentiality applies to everything the client shares with the firm.

Conflict of interest **conflicto de intereses**

Situation where the representative's or other clients' interests may affect the representation.

Check for any conflict of interest before accepting the case.

Consular officer **funcionario consular**

Department of State official who decides visa applications abroad.

The consular officer asked about the couple's relationship.

Consular processing **trámite consular**

Obtaining an immigrant visa at a U.S. embassy or consulate abroad.

The beneficiary will complete consular processing in her home country.

Continuance **aplazamiento**

Postponement of a hearing to a later date, granted by the judge for good cause.

The judge granted a continuance so the respondent could obtain counsel.

Continuous residence **residencia continua**

Requirement to live in the country without long absences that break the required period.

Long trips abroad may break continuous residence.

Corroborating evidence **prueba corroborativa**

Evidence that confirms or supports testimony or other evidence in the case.

Medical records are strong corroborating evidence of the injuries.

Country conditions **condiciones del país**

Objective information about human rights and safety conditions in the home country.

The country conditions report supports the client's testimony.

Court disposition **resolución penal certificada**

Certified criminal court record showing the final outcome of a case.

Obtain the certified court disposition for every arrest.

Credibility **credibilidad**

The degree to which the applicant's testimony is found believable, consistent, and plausible.

Minor inconsistencies should be explained to protect credibility.

C – D

Credible fear interview **entrevista de miedo creíble**

Interview to determine whether there is a significant possibility of obtaining asylum or protection.

The asylum officer conducted the credible fear interview by phone.

Cross-examination **contrainterrogatorio**

Questions the opposing party asks a witness after direct examination.

The government attorney began the cross-examination after a short recess.

Custody redetermination **revisión de custodia**

Request asking the immigration judge to review a custody or bond decision.

Counsel requested a custody redetermination before the immigration judge.

Declaration **declaración**

Written statement signed under penalty of perjury, without the need for a notary.

The client's declaration explains each event in chronological order.

Defensive asylum **asilo defensivo**

Asylum application filed before the immigration judge as a defense against removal.

He is pursuing defensive asylum in immigration court.

Deferred action **acción diferida**

Discretionary decision to temporarily not pursue removal; it does not confer lawful status.

Deferred action does not provide a path to permanent residence by itself.

Delivery bond **fianza de entrega**

Bond guaranteeing the released person will appear whenever required by the authorities.

The delivery bond was posted at the local field office.

Denaturalization **desnaturalización**

Court revocation of citizenship obtained illegally or through fraud.

Denaturalization cases are handled in federal court.

Derivative beneficiary **beneficiario derivado**

Spouse or child who receives an immigration benefit through the principal beneficiary.

The children are listed as derivative beneficiaries on the petition.

Derived citizenship **ciudadanía derivada**

Citizenship a child obtains automatically through a parent's naturalization.

The client may have derived citizenship when his father naturalized.

Detainee **persona detenida**

A person held in immigration custody.

The detainee may receive legal visits during scheduled hours.

Detainer **solicitud de retención**

ICE request asking a law enforcement agency to hold a person or give notice of release.

The county jail received a detainer for the client.

D – E

Detention center **centro de detención**

Facility where people are held in immigration custody.

The attorney scheduled a legal call with the detention center.

Due diligence **diligencia debida**

Reasonable care and promptness in handling a case.

Due diligence requires checking deadlines as soon as the file opens.

Duty of candor **deber de veracidad**

Obligation not to mislead the tribunal and to correct false statements.

The duty of candor applies to every filing before the court.

Employment authorization **autorización de empleo**

Government permission to work lawfully in the United States.

She applied for employment authorization based on her pending application.

Engagement letter **contrato de servicios**

Written agreement defining the scope of representation, fees, and responsibilities.

The engagement letter describes exactly which services are included.

English test **examen de inglés**

Assessment of English reading, writing, and speaking at the naturalization interview.

The officer administered the English test at the start of the interview.

Entry without inspection **entrada sin inspección**

Entering the country without being inspected and admitted by an officer at a port of entry.

Entry without inspection affects eligibility for adjustment of status.

Exhibit **prueba documental**

Document or item of evidence formally marked and submitted to the court.

Each exhibit should be tabbed and listed in the index.

Expedite request **solicitud de trámite urgente**

Request asking the agency to speed up a case for justified reasons.

We submitted an expedite request with medical documentation.

Expedited removal **deportación acelerada**

Removal without a hearing before a judge, carried out by immigration officers in certain cases.

He was placed in expedited removal shortly after arriving.

Expert witness **perito**

Witness with specialized knowledge who offers technical opinions to the court.

The expert witness testified about conditions in the region.

Extreme hardship **dificultad extrema**

Standard of harm to qualifying relatives required for certain immigration waivers.

The waiver application documents extreme hardship to the U.S. citizen spouse.

F – I

Factual allegations **alegaciones de hecho**

Facts the government asserts about the person in the charging document.

The respondent admitted the factual allegations but contested the charge.

Filing fee **tarifa de presentación**

Payment the agency requires to process an application or petition.

Confirm the current filing fee on the agency website before submitting.

Firm resettlement **reasentamiento firme**

An offer of permanent status in another country before arrival; may bar asylum.

The government argued that firm resettlement barred the claim.

Flight risk **riesgo de fuga**

Likelihood that a person will not appear for hearings if released.

Strong family ties can help show the respondent is not a flight risk.

Frivolous filing **presentación frívola**

Filing without a reasonable legal or factual basis; may lead to disciplinary sanctions.

A frivolous filing can lead to disciplinary action against the practitioner.

Good moral character **buen carácter moral**

Requirement of ethical and lawful conduct during the period required for naturalization.

Unpaid taxes may raise questions about good moral character.

Green card **tarjeta de residencia**

Common name for the card that proves lawful permanent residence.

Carry your green card when traveling internationally.

Hearsay **testimonio de oídas**

Out-of-court statement offered as evidence; often admissible in immigration court, with varying weight.

Hearsay may be admitted in immigration court if it is reliable.

Humanitarian parole **permiso humanitario**

Discretionary temporary entry for urgent humanitarian reasons or significant public benefit.

The family requested humanitarian parole for an urgent medical reason.

Immediate relative **familiar inmediato**

Close relatives of U.S. citizens who are not subject to annual visa limits.

Spouses of U.S. citizens are immediate relatives under immigration law.

Immigrant visa **visa de inmigrante**

Visa for someone who intends to live permanently in the United States.

The immigrant visa allows entry as a lawful permanent resident.

Immigration bond **fianza migratoria**

Financial guarantee that allows a detained person's release while the case continues.

The family paid the immigration bond the same afternoon.

I – M

Immigration judge **juez de inmigración**

Department of Justice official who presides over and decides immigration court proceedings.

The immigration judge asked whether the respondent understood the proceedings.

In absentia order **orden en ausencia**

Removal order issued when the respondent fails to appear for a hearing.

The respondent received an in absentia order after missing the hearing.

Inadmissibility **inadmisibilidad**

Legal grounds that bar a visa, admission, or adjustment of status.

Prior immigration violations may create grounds of inadmissibility.

Individual hearing **audiencia individual**

Merits hearing where evidence and testimony are presented to decide the relief application.

Please submit all evidence before the individual hearing.

Ineffective assistance of counsel **asistencia legal ineficaz**

Deficient representation that harms the case; may support a motion to reopen.

The motion alleges ineffective assistance of counsel by the prior attorney.

Informed consent **consentimiento informado**

Client's authorization after a sufficient explanation of risks and alternatives.

Obtain informed consent before sharing the file with co-counsel.

Interview notice **notificación de entrevista**

Notice stating the date, time, and place of the agency interview.

The interview notice lists the documents you must bring.

Joint sponsor **copatrocinador**

Additional person who takes on the support obligation when the petitioner's income is insufficient.

A joint sponsor signed a separate affidavit of support.

Lawful permanent resident **residente permanente legal**

A person authorized to live and work permanently in the United States.

As a lawful permanent resident, he may later apply for citizenship.

Mandatory detention **detención obligatoria**

Detention required by law for certain people, generally without bond eligibility.

The judge found that the respondent was not subject to mandatory detention.

Master calendar hearing **audiencia preliminar**

Short hearing addressing allegations, charges, relief applications, and scheduling.

The client must attend the master calendar hearing in person.

Medical disability exception **excepción por discapacidad médica**

Exemption from the English or civics tests for a disability certified by a doctor.

The applicant requested a medical disability exception with a doctor's certification.

M – O

Misrepresentation **tergiversación**

False statement of a material fact to obtain an immigration benefit; may cause inadmissibility.

Misrepresentation on a visa application can have lasting consequences.

Motion to reconsider **moción de reconsideración**

Request to review a decision for errors of fact or law.

The attorney filed a motion to reconsider the denial.

Motion to reopen **moción para reabrir**

Request to reopen a decided case based on new facts or evidence.

The motion to reopen includes new evidence of country conditions.

Naturalization **naturalización**

Process by which a permanent resident becomes a U.S. citizen.

He applied for naturalization after meeting the residence requirements.

Naturalization interview **entrevista de naturalización**

Interview where an officer reviews the application and gives the required tests.

Bring your green card and passport to the naturalization interview.

Nexus **nexo causal**

The link between the persecution suffered or feared and a protected ground.

The brief focuses on the nexus between the harm and political opinion.

Nonimmigrant visa **visa de no inmigrante**

Visa for a temporary stay with a specific purpose, such as tourism or study.

He traveled on a nonimmigrant visa for a short business trip.

Notario fraud **fraude de notarios**

Deception by people who falsely present themselves as authorized to give immigration legal advice.

The community workshop warned families about notario fraud.

Notice of appeal **notificación de apelación**

Document that formally starts an appeal and identifies the decision challenged.

Counsel submitted the notice of appeal through the electronic system.

Notice of appearance **aviso de representación**

Form that formally registers the representative with the court or agency.

File the notice of appearance before the first hearing.

Notice of intent to deny **aviso de intención de denegar**

Notice of the intent to deny a case, allowing a response first.

We must respond to the notice of intent to deny with strong evidence.

Oath ceremony **ceremonia de juramento**

Public ceremony where the applicant takes the oath and becomes a citizen.

Family members may attend the oath ceremony.

O – P

Oath of Allegiance **juramento de lealtad**

Oath by which the applicant officially becomes a U.S. citizen.

She took the Oath of Allegiance with hundreds of new citizens.

Order of removal **orden de deportación**

Decision ordering a person to leave the United States.

The judge entered an order of removal at the end of the hearing.

Order of supervision **orden de supervisión**

Order allowing a person with a final order to live outside detention under conditions.

He reports to the immigration office under an order of supervision.

Overstay **permanencia excedida**

Remaining in the country beyond the period authorized at admission.

The overstay began when his authorized stay expired.

Panel physician **médico de panel**

Physician designated by the Department of State to perform the immigration medical exam abroad.

The applicant must complete the medical exam with a panel physician.

Parole **permiso de permanencia temporal**

Discretionary permission to enter or remain temporarily; it is not an admission.

Parole allows temporary presence but is not an admission.

Particular social group **grupo social determinado**

Protected ground: group sharing an immutable characteristic, defined with particularity and socially distinct.

Counsel carefully defined the particular social group in the brief.

Penalty of perjury **pena de perjurio**

Legal penalty for knowingly making false statements after swearing or affirming to tell the truth.

I declare under penalty of perjury that the information is true.

Persecution **persecución**

Serious harm inflicted by the government or by actors it cannot or will not control.

The applicant described past persecution in detail.

Persecutor bar **impedimento por persecutor**

Bar to asylum and other protection for those who took part in persecuting others.

The judge considered whether the persecutor bar applied.

Petition for review **petición de revisión**

Federal court of appeals challenge to a final BIA decision.

The attorney filed a petition for review in federal court.

Petitioner **petionario**

U.S. citizen or resident who files a petition on behalf of a relative.

The petitioner must prove the family relationship.

P

Physical presence **presencia física**

Time actually spent inside the country; a requirement distinct from continuous residence.

Count all trips abroad to calculate physical presence.

Pleadings **contestación de alegaciones**

The respondent's response admitting or denying the allegations and charges.

The respondent is ready to enter pleadings today, Your Honor.

Police certificate **certificado de antecedentes policiales**

Official criminal record document issued by a country's authorities.

The consulate requires a police certificate from each country of residence.

Port of entry **puerto de entrada**

Authorized place, such as an airport or land border, where travelers are inspected.

She was inspected and admitted at the port of entry.

Precedent decision **decisión precedente**

Published decision that is binding in later cases raising similar issues.

The judge relied on a recent precedent decision of the Board.

Preponderance of the evidence **preponderancia de la prueba**

Evidentiary standard requiring proof that a fact is more likely true than not.

The applicant must establish eligibility by a preponderance of the evidence.

Priority date **fecha de prioridad**

Date that sets the applicant's place in line for an immigrant visa.

Her priority date is the date the petition was filed.

Pro bono **gratuito**

Legal representation provided without charging fees.

The organization connects detained respondents with pro bono attorneys.

Pro se **sin representación legal**

A person handling their own case without an attorney or representative.

The respondent appeared pro se at the first hearing.

Prosecutorial discretion **discreción procesal**

The government's authority to decide whether to start, continue, or prioritize an immigration case.

Counsel sent a request for prosecutorial discretion to the government attorney.

Protected ground **motivo protegido**

Race, religion, nationality, political opinion, or membership in a particular social group.

The harm must be connected to a protected ground.

Public charge **carga pública**

Inadmissibility ground based on likely primary dependence on certain public benefits.

The officer evaluated public charge factors at the interview.

R

Receipt notice **notificación de recibo**

Notice confirming the agency received the filing and assigning a case number.

Use the receipt number on the receipt notice to check case status.

Recognized organization **organización reconocida**

Nonprofit organization authorized by DOJ to provide immigration legal services.

The recognized organization employs two accredited representatives.

Record of proceedings **expediente del caso**

Official file containing the documents, evidence, and transcripts of the proceeding.

Request a copy of the record of proceedings before drafting the brief.

Reentry permit **permiso de reingreso**

Document that helps a permanent resident return after a long absence.

The resident applied for a reentry permit before her extended trip.

Refugee **refugiado**

Person outside their country with a well-founded fear of persecution on a protected ground.

Refugee status is usually requested from outside the United States.

Reinstatement of removal **restablecimiento de orden de deportación**

Reactivation of a prior removal order against someone who reentered unlawfully after removal.

The officer issued a reinstatement of removal after reviewing the record.

Release on recognizance **liberación bajo palabra**

Release of a detained person without bond, on their promise to meet conditions.

The client was granted release on recognizance with reporting requirements.

Relief from removal **alivio contra la deportación**

Benefit or protection that lets a person avoid removal or remain lawfully.

The respondent is seeking relief from removal based on family ties.

Remand **devolución del caso**

Sending a case back to the lower judge or agency for further proceedings.

The Board ordered a remand for further fact-finding.

Removal proceedings **procedimiento de deportación**

Immigration court process to determine whether a person should be removed.

The client was placed in removal proceedings last year.

Request for evidence **solicitud de evidencia**

Agency request that the applicant submit additional documents or information.

The officer issued a request for evidence about the marriage.

Respondent **demandado**

A person facing removal proceedings in immigration court.

The respondent appeared with counsel and an interpreter.

S – V

Standard of review **estándar de revisión**

Degree of deference with which the appellate body reviews the lower decision.

The brief must address the correct standard of review.

Stay of removal **suspensión de la deportación**

Order temporarily suspending the execution of a removal.

Counsel requested a stay of removal while the motion is pending.

Subpoena **citación judicial**

Order requiring a person to testify or produce documents.

The judge may issue a subpoena for a witness or records.

Summary dismissal **desestimación sumaria**

Dismissal of an appeal without reaching the merits, due to procedural defects.

The appeal risked summary dismissal because no brief was filed.

Testimony **testimonio**

Oral statement a witness gives under oath during the hearing.

Her testimony was consistent with the written declaration.

Torture **tortura**

Severe pain or suffering intentionally inflicted with a public official's involvement or acquiescence.

The application includes a claim for protection against torture.

Transcript **transcripción**

Written, word-for-word record of what was said at the hearing.

The transcript shows that the interpreter omitted part of the answer.

Trial attorney **abogado del gobierno**

DHS attorney who represents the government in immigration court.

The trial attorney did not oppose the motion.

Unauthorized practice of law **ejercicio no autorizado del derecho**

Providing legal services by someone not authorized to practice law.

Selecting immigration forms for a client may be unauthorized practice of law.

Unlawful presence **presencia ilegal**

Time in the country without authorization that can trigger bars to returning.

Leaving the country after unlawful presence may trigger a reentry bar.

Visa bulletin **boletín de visas**

Monthly Department of State publication showing which priority dates are current.

Check the visa bulletin to see whether the priority date is current.

Visa refusal **negativa de visa**

A consular officer's decision not to issue the requested visa.

The visa refusal letter cited missing documents.

The judge granted voluntary departure with conditions.

The applicant needs a waiver before the immigrant visa can be issued.

The judge must approve the withdrawal of counsel.

The judge granted withholding of removal but denied asylum.

Appeal · Appellant · Brief · Circuit court · Ineffective assistance of counsel · Motion to reconsider · Motion to reopen · Notice of appeal · Petition for review · Precedent decision · Record of proceedings · Remand · Standard of review · Stay of removal · Summary dismissal · Transcript

Acquiescence · Affirmative asylum · Asylee · Asylum officer · Country conditions · Credibility · Credible fear interview · Defensive asylum · Firm resettlement · Nexus · Particular social group · Persecution · Persecutor bar · Protected ground · Refugee · Torture · Withholding of removal

Administrative processing · Admissibility · Admission · Consular officer · Consular processing · Immigrant visa · Inadmissibility · Misrepresentation · Nonimmigrant visa · Panel physician · Police certificate · Port of entry · Public charge · Visa bulletin · Visa refusal

Alternatives to detention · Bond hearing · Bond obligor · Custody redetermination · Delivery bond · Detainee · Detainer · Detention center · Expedited removal · Flight risk · Immigration bond · Mandatory detention · Order of supervision · Reinstatement of removal · Release on recognizance

Accredited representative · Attorney of record · Confidentiality · Conflict of interest · Due diligence · Duty of candor · Engagement letter · Frivolous filing · Informed consent · Notario fraud · Notice of appearance · Pro bono · Pro se · Recognized organization · Unauthorized practice of law · Withdrawal of counsel

Affidavit · Apostille · Authentication · Burden of proof · Certified translation · Corroborating evidence · Court disposition · Declaration · Exhibit · Expert witness · Hearsay · Penalty of perjury · Preponderance of the evidence · Subpoena · Testimony

Adjustment of status · Affidavit of support · Beneficiary · Bona fide marriage · Civil surgeon · Conditional permanent resident · Derivative beneficiary · Entry without inspection · Extreme hardship · Green card · Immediate relative · Joint sponsor · Lawful permanent resident · Overstay · Petitioner · Priority date · Unlawful presence · Waiver

Administrative closure · Cancellation of removal · Change of venue · Charge of removability · Continuance · Cross-examination · Factual allegations · Immigration judge · In absentia order · Individual hearing · Master calendar hearing · Order of removal · Pleadings · Prosecutorial discretion · Relief from removal · Removal proceedings · Respondent · Trial attorney · Voluntary departure

Acquisition of citizenship · Certificate of naturalization · Civics test · Continuous residence ·
Denaturalization · Derived citizenship · English test · Good moral character · Medical disability exception ·
Naturalization · Naturalization interview · Oath ceremony · Oath of Allegiance · Physical presence

Adjudication · Advance parole · Background check · Biometrics appointment · Deferred action · Employment authorization · Expedite request · Filing fee · Humanitarian parole · Interview notice · Notice of intent to deny · Parole · Receipt notice · Reentry permit · Request for evidence

FALSE FRIENDS

Terms that can confuse

Words that look like Spanish words but mean something else in a legal context. A mistake here can change the meaning of a filing or an interpretation.

TERM	LOOKS LIKE	ACTUALLY MEANS
Actual	actual	real or concrete (actual harm); “actual” in Spanish means current
Admission	admisión	lawful entry after inspection; not the same as mere presence
Advise	avisar	to give advice or counsel; “avisar” is notify or inform
Application	aplicación	a request for a benefit filed by the person seeking it
Assist	asistir	to help or support; “asistir a” is attend
Attend	atender	to be present or appear (attend a hearing)
Brief	breve	a written legal argument filed with the court
Conviction	convicción	a criminal conviction, as defined by immigration law
Counsel	consejo	an attorney or legal representative; also legal advice
Demand	demanda	a request or claim; a lawsuit is a complaint
Discovery	descubrimiento	formal exchange of evidence between parties; very limited in immigration court
Disposition	disposición	the final outcome of a case, especially a criminal one

🔗 OTHERS I HAVE FOUND

🔗 NOTES

FALSE FRIENDS

Continued

TERM	LOOKS LIKE	ACTUALLY MEANS
Eventually	eventualmente	finally, in the end; not “possibly”
Facility	facilidad	a building or center (detention facility)
Felony	felonía	a serious crime in the U.S. criminal system
Motion	movimiento	a formal request, written or oral, made to the court
Notice	noticia	an official notification or notice
Parole	libertad condicional	in immigration: discretionary permission to enter or stay temporarily, not an admission
Petition	petición, ruego	a formal request a petitioner files on behalf of another person
Record	récord	the official case file; also a criminal history (criminal record)
Relief	alivio	a legal benefit or protection requested, e.g., against removal
Removal	remoción, traslado	deportation: departure ordered in immigration proceedings
Sentence	sentencia	the punishment imposed in a criminal case; a ruling is a judgment or decision
Support	soportar, aguantar	to back, to provide financial support, or to corroborate with evidence

🔗 OTHERS I HAVE FOUND

🔗 NOTES

Verbs for immigration practice

 **NOTES**

Continued

VERB	SPANISH	EXAMPLE
continue	aplazar	<i>The judge continued the case to a later date.</i>
corroborate	corroborar	<i>These letters corroborate the client's testimony.</i>
cross-examine	contrainterrogar	<i>The trial attorney will cross-examine the witness.</i>
deny	negar, denegar	<i>The respondent denies the charge of removability.</i>
detain	detener	<i>ICE may detain individuals during removal proceedings.</i>
dismiss	desestimar	<i>The Board dismissed the appeal.</i>
enter	registrar, presentar	<i>Counsel entered an appearance on behalf of the respondent.</i>
expedite	agilizar	<i>We asked the agency to expedite the case.</i>
file	presentar, radicar	<i>Please file the motion with proof of service.</i>
grant	conceder, otorgar	<i>The judge granted the application for relief.</i>
impeach	impugnar la credibilidad	<i>The attorney tried to impeach the witness with prior statements.</i>
interpret	interpretar	<i>The interpreter will interpret everything said in the courtroom.</i>
issue	emitir, expedir	<i>The consulate issued the immigrant visa last week.</i>
naturalize	naturalizarse	<i>She naturalized and later petitioned for her parents.</i>
notarize	notarizar	<i>The affidavit was notarized before submission.</i>

 NOTES

Continued

VERB	SPANISH	EXAMPLE
object	objetar	<i>Your Honor, I object to this question.</i>
overrule	denegar (una objeción)	<i>The judge overruled the objection.</i>
petition	presentar una petición	<i>He petitioned for his unmarried daughter.</i>
plead	contestar los cargos	<i>The respondent is ready to plead today.</i>
proffer	ofrecer como prueba	<i>Counsel proffered the expected testimony of the witness.</i>
reconsider	reconsiderar	<i>We ask the Board to reconsider its decision.</i>
redact	testar, tachar	<i>Redact personal identifiers before sharing the document.</i>
reinstate	restablecer	<i>The officer reinstated the prior removal order.</i>
release	liberar	<i>ICE released him on an order of supervision.</i>
remand	devolver (un caso)	<i>The Board remanded the case to the immigration judge.</i>
remove	deportar	<i>The government seeks to remove the respondent.</i>
reopen	reabrir	<i>The judge agreed to reopen the proceedings.</i>
represent	representar	<i>Our firm will represent the client in court.</i>
rescind	rescindir, anular	<i>The court may rescind an in absentia order in limited circumstances.</i>
revoke	revocar	<i>The agency may revoke an approved petition for cause.</i>

 NOTES

Continued

VERB	SPANISH	EXAMPLE
schedule	programar, agendar	<i>The court scheduled an individual hearing.</i>
serve	notificar, entregar	<i>Serve a copy of the motion on the opposing party.</i>
sponsor	patrocinar	<i>Her brother agreed to sponsor her financially.</i>
stipulate	estipular, acordar	<i>The parties stipulate to the identity of the respondent.</i>
submit	presentar, entregar	<i>Submit the evidence before the court's filing deadline.</i>
subpoena	citar judicialmente	<i>The court may subpoena a witness when necessary.</i>
substantiate	fundamentar, probar	<i>Documents must substantiate the claimed relationship.</i>
sustain	admitir (una objeción)	<i>Objection sustained; please rephrase the question.</i>
swear	jurar	<i>Please raise your right hand to swear in.</i>
terminate	terminar, dar por concluido	<i>The judge terminated proceedings without prejudice.</i>
testify	testificar, declarar	<i>The client will testify in Spanish.</i>
translate	traducir	<i>Translate every foreign document into English.</i>
vacate	anular, dejar sin efecto	<i>The Board vacated the decision and remanded the record.</i>
waive	renunciar a; perdonar	<i>The respondent waives a formal reading of the charges.</i>
withdraw	retirar, desistir	<i>Counsel moved to withdraw from representation.</i>

 NOTES

Legal phrases in English

Language structures to recognize and practice. They are not models to file without review by someone who is authorized.

In immigration court

IN ENGLISH	IN SPANISH
Your Honor, the respondent respectfully requests a continuance to obtain counsel.	Su Señoría, el demandado solicita respetuosamente un aplazamiento para obtener representación legal.
Good morning, Your Honor. Counsel for the respondent, ready to proceed.	Buenos días, Su Señoría. Abogado del demandado, listo para proceder.
The respondent admits the factual allegations and concedes the charge.	El demandado admite las alegaciones de hecho y acepta el cargo.
The respondent denies the allegations and does not concede removability.	El demandado niega las alegaciones y no acepta la deportabilidad.
We designate the country of removal as stated in the record.	Designamos el país de deportación según consta en el expediente.
Objection, Your Honor; the question calls for speculation.	Objeción, Su Señoría; la pregunta exige especular.
May I approach the witness, Your Honor?	¿Puedo acercarme al testigo, Su Señoría?
The respondent intends to apply for relief and requests a filing date.	El demandado tiene intención de solicitar alivio y pide una fecha de presentación.
Could the interpreter please repeat the last answer?	¿Podría el intérprete repetir la última respuesta, por favor?

With USCIS and other agencies

IN ENGLISH	IN SPANISH
I am calling regarding the status of a pending application.	Llamo para consultar el estado de una solicitud pendiente.
Please find enclosed our response to the request for evidence.	Adjuntamos nuestra respuesta a la solicitud de evidencia.
The applicant respectfully requests that the interview be rescheduled.	El solicitante pide respetuosamente que se reprograme la entrevista.
We are writing to notify you of a change of address.	Les escribimos para notificar un cambio de domicilio.
Could you confirm that the notice of representation was received?	¿Podrían confirmar que recibieron el aviso de representación?
The case has exceeded normal processing times.	El caso ha superado los tiempos normales de procesamiento.
We respectfully request that this case be expedited.	Solicitamos respetuosamente que se agilice este caso.
I will appear at the interview as the applicant's attorney.	Compareceré a la entrevista como abogado del solicitante.
Please direct all future correspondence to our office.	Por favor, envíen toda correspondencia futura a nuestra oficina.

USEFUL PHRASES

Continued

In writing: emails and letters

IN ENGLISH	IN SPANISH
Thank you for your prompt response.	Gracias por su pronta respuesta.
Please see the attached documents for your review.	Adjunto los documentos para su revisión.
I am following up on my previous email.	Le escribo para dar seguimiento a mi correo anterior.
Please let me know if you need any additional information.	Avíseme si necesita información adicional.
We acknowledge receipt of your letter.	Acusamos recibo de su carta.
This message contains confidential attorney-client communications.	Este mensaje contiene comunicaciones confidenciales entre abogado y cliente.
I look forward to hearing from you.	Quedo a la espera de su respuesta.
Please accept our apologies for the delay.	Le ofrecemos disculpas por la demora.
Do not hesitate to contact our office with any questions.	No dude en comunicarse con nuestra oficina si tiene preguntas.

With colleagues and opposing counsel

IN ENGLISH	IN SPANISH
Would the government consider joining a motion to reopen?	¿Consideraría el gobierno presentar una moción conjunta para reabrir?
Does the government oppose our motion?	¿Se opone el gobierno a nuestra moción?
We would like to discuss narrowing the issues before the hearing.	Quisiéramos conversar para delimitar los temas antes de la audiencia.
Are you available for a brief call this week?	¿Está disponible para una llamada breve esta semana?
I am substituting as counsel on this matter.	Asumo la representación en este asunto en sustitución del abogado anterior.
Can we stipulate to the authenticity of these documents?	¿Podemos estipular la autenticidad de estos documentos?
Please confirm whether the government will be filing a brief.	Por favor, confirme si el gobierno presentará un escrito.
I am sending a courtesy copy of our filing.	Le envío una copia de cortesía de nuestro escrito.
Thank you for your professional courtesy.	Gracias por su cortesía profesional.

 NOTES

Continued

IN ENGLISH

Please let me know if any word is unclear.

If you do not understand a question, say so.

It is important to always tell the truth.

Everything you tell me is confidential.

Please bring all original documents to the next appointment.

We will review your testimony together before the hearing.

Do you have any questions about what happened today?

IN SPANISH

Por favor, interprete todo lo que digo en primera persona.

Por favor, avíseme si alguna palabra no está clara.

Por favor, responda solo la pregunta que se le hizo.

Si no entiende una pregunta, dígalo.

Es importante decir siempre la verdad.

Todo lo que usted me cuente es confidencial.

Por favor, traiga todos los documentos originales a la próxima cita.

Repasaremos juntos su testimonio antes de la audiencia.

¿Tiene alguna pregunta sobre lo que ocurrió hoy?

 NOTES

Phrases I want to remember

Immigration acronyms

Agencies, offices and programs change names or structure. Verify the current acronym at the official source.

ACRONYM	FULL NAME	WHAT IT IS
AAO	Administrative Appeals Office	USCIS office that decides certain administrative appeals
ACC	Assistant Chief Counsel	DHS attorney appearing in immigration court
AEDPA	Antiterrorism and Effective Death Penalty Act	1996 federal law with major immigration consequences
AILA	American Immigration Lawyers Association	National association of immigration attorneys
AOS	Adjustment of Status	Becoming a permanent resident from inside the U.S.
AP	Advance Parole	Travel document allowing return to the U.S.
ASC	Application Support Center	USCIS site for biometrics appointments
ATD	Alternatives to Detention	Supervision programs used instead of detention
BIA	Board of Immigration Appeals	EOIR's appellate body for immigration decisions
CAT	Convention Against Torture	Treaty against torture; related protection from removal
CBP	U.S. Customs and Border Protection	Agency guarding borders and ports of entry
CFR	Code of Federal Regulations	Compiled federal agency regulations
CP	Consular Processing	Obtaining an immigrant visa abroad
CPR	Conditional Permanent Resident	Two-year resident who must remove conditions
CSPA	Child Status Protection Act	Law protecting certain child beneficiaries from aging out
DACA	Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals	Deferred action for people brought as children
DED	Deferred Enforced Departure	Discretionary deferral of departure for certain nationalities
DHS	Department of Homeland Security	Federal department over USCIS, ICE, and CBP
DOJ	Department of Justice	Federal department that includes EOIR
DOL	Department of Labor	Federal labor department; handles labor certification
DOS	Department of State	Federal department that oversees consulates
DV	Diversity Visa	Visa lottery program
EAD	Employment Authorization Document	Work permit card
ECAS	EOIR Courts & Appeals System	EOIR electronic filing and case records system
EOIR	Executive Office for Immigration Review	Office that runs immigration courts and the BIA

Continued

ACRONYM	FULL NAME	WHAT IT IS
ERO	Enforcement and Removal Operations	ICE division handling detention and removals
ESTA	Electronic System for Travel Authorization	Online travel authorization for Visa Waiver Program
EWI	Entry Without Inspection	Entry without inspection at a port of entry
FBI	Federal Bureau of Investigation	Federal agency; background and fingerprint checks
FDNS	Fraud Detection and National Security	USCIS directorate addressing fraud and security risks
FOIA	Freedom of Information Act	Law allowing requests for government records
HSI	Homeland Security Investigations	ICE investigative division
ICE	U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement	Agency enforcing immigration laws inside the U.S.
IIRIRA	Illegal Immigration Reform and Immigrant Responsibility Act	1996 immigration reform law
IJ	Immigration Judge	Judge presiding over immigration court
INA	Immigration and Nationality Act	Main federal immigration statute
INS	Immigration and Naturalization Service	Former immigration agency, replaced by DHS
IR	Immediate Relative	Close relative of a U.S. citizen
LOP	Legal Orientation Program	Legal orientation program for people in proceedings
LPR	Lawful Permanent Resident	Green card holder
MCH	Master Calendar Hearing	Preliminary hearing in immigration court
MPP	Migrant Protection Protocols	Border program requiring waiting in Mexico
MTR	Motion to Reopen	Request to reopen a decided case
NACARA	Nicaraguan Adjustment and Central American Relief Act	Relief law for certain Central Americans and others
NOA	Notice of Action	USCIS notice (receipt, approval, etc.)
NOID	Notice of Intent to Deny	Notice that the agency intends to deny
NOIR	Notice of Intent to Revoke	Notice that the agency intends to revoke
NOIT	Notice of Intent to Terminate	Notice of intent to end a status or benefit
NTA	Notice to Appear	Charging document that starts removal proceedings
NVC	National Visa Center	State Department center processing immigrant visa cases

Continued

ACRONYM	FULL NAME	WHAT IT IS
OCIJ	Office of the Chief Immigration Judge	Office overseeing the immigration courts
OIL	Office of Immigration Litigation	DOJ office litigating immigration cases in federal court
OPLA	Office of the Principal Legal Advisor	ICE legal office; represents DHS in court
OPT	Optional Practical Training	Work training for F-1 students
ORR	Office of Refugee Resettlement	HHS office caring for unaccompanied children
OSC	Order to Show Cause	Former charging document that started deportation
PD	Priority Date	Date setting place in the visa line
PERM	Program Electronic Review Management	DOL labor certification system
POE	Port of Entry	Authorized place where travelers are inspected
PSG	Particular Social Group	Protected ground for asylum
R&A	Recognition and Accreditation	DOJ program for recognized organizations and accredited representatives
RFE	Request for Evidence	Agency request for more documents
ROP	Record of Proceedings	Official EOIR case file
SAVE	Systematic Alien Verification for Entitlements	Status verification system for public benefits
SEVIS	Student and Exchange Visitor Information System	Registration system for students and exchange visitors
SIJS	Special Immigrant Juvenile Status	Status for certain abused, abandoned, or neglected children
TPS	Temporary Protected Status	Temporary protection for nationals of designated countries
TRIG	Terrorism-Related Inadmissibility Grounds	Terrorism-related grounds of inadmissibility
UAC	Unaccompanied Alien Child	Child arriving without a parent or legal guardian
UPL	Unauthorized Practice of Law	Practicing law without authorization
USC	United States Citizen	Citizen of the United States
USCIS	U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services	Agency deciding immigration benefits
VAWA	Violence Against Women Act	Law allowing self-petitions for certain abuse survivors
VWP	Visa Waiver Program	Program allowing visa-free short visits
WOR	Withholding of Removal	Protection from removal to a country of danger



MY GROWTH





How to use this section

Professional growth does not come from years of experience alone. It happens when you stop to look at where you are, decide what you want to develop and ask for help to get there. These pages walk with you through that process.

Direction

- My professional development plan
- Skills matrix (twice a year)

Boundaries

- My professional boundaries
- My non-negotiables

Mentoring

- Mentoring sessions
- Questions for my mentor

Well-being

- My wins
- Gratitude in practice
- Professional well-being
- Later · Someday

Growing also means deciding what you will no longer carry.



My development plan



 WHERE I WANT TO BE PROFESSIONALLY IN THREE YEARS

AREA	GOAL	ACTIONS	DATE	ACHIEVED
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

 WHO CAN HELP ME

 RESOURCES I NEED

First self-assessment · January

Rate yourself from 1 (just starting) to 5 (I could teach it). Be honest with yourself: this page is for you alone.

SKILL	TODAY	GOAL	HOW I WILL DEVELOP IT
Legal research			
Legal writing			
Hearings and litigation			
Client interviewing			
Legal English			
Ethics and compliance			
Case management			
Technology and AI			
Team leadership			
Communication			
Business and finance			
Professional well-being			
💡 THE TWO SKILLS I WILL FOCUS ON			
✍️ NOTES			

Second self-assessment · July

Rate yourself from 1 (just starting) to 5 (I could teach it). Be honest with yourself: this page is for you alone.

SKILL	TODAY	GOAL	HOW I WILL DEVELOP IT
Legal research			
Legal writing			
Hearings and litigation			
Client interviewing			
Legal English			
Ethics and compliance			
Case management			
Technology and AI			
Team leadership			
Communication			
Business and finance			
Professional well-being			
💡 THE TWO SKILLS I WILL FOCUS ON			
✍️ NOTES			

My professional boundaries

A clear boundary protects your clients, your team and you.

 MY WORKING AND CLIENT-SERVICE HOURS

 CHANNELS I RESPOND ON AND WHICH I DO NOT

 WHAT I DO WITH AFTER-HOURS MESSAGES

 CASES OR TASKS I DO NOT ACCEPT

 HOW I COMMUNICATE A BOUNDARY RESPECTFULLY

 NOTES

BOUNDARIES

My non-negotiables

What you will not negotiate, even under pressure, in a rush or with money on the table.

#	MY NON-NEGOTIABLE	WHY
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		
8		
9		
10		
📅 THE LAST TIME I HELD TO IT AND WHAT I LEARNED		
✍️ NOTES		

Mentoring session 1

MENTOR	DATE	FORMAT
--------	------	--------

 WHAT I WANT FROM THIS SESSION

 QUESTIONS I AM BRINGING

 WHAT I LEARNED

 NOTES

Session 1 · action items

AGREED ACTION	DATE	DONE
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

 WHAT I TAKE FROM THIS CONVERSATION

 NEXT SESSION

Mentoring information: lcdajessicalperezsalazar.com

 NOTES

Mentoring session 2

MENTOR	DATE	FORMAT
--------	------	--------

 WHAT I WANT FROM THIS SESSION

 QUESTIONS I AM BRINGING

 WHAT I LEARNED

 NOTES

Session 2 · action items

AGREED ACTION	DATE	DONE
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

 WHAT I TAKE FROM THIS CONVERSATION

 NEXT SESSION

Mentoring information: lcdajessicalperezsalazar.com

 NOTES

Questions for my mentor

WINS

My professional wins



DATE _____

WHAT MADE IT POSSIBLE

GRATITUDE

Gratitude in practice

 PEOPLE WHO MADE A DIFFERENCE THIS YEAR

 MOMENTS I WANT TO REMEMBER

 WHAT I AM GRATEFUL FOR IN MY WORK

 WHOM I WANT TO THANK

 NOTES

Professional well-being

Once a month, rate from 1 to 5 how you are doing. The goal is to notice early when something starts to weigh on you.

MONTH	ENERGY	REST	LIMITS	WHAT RECHARGED ME
January				
February				
March				
April				
May				
June				
July				
August				
September				
October				
November				
December				

 NOTES

Signs and resources

 SIGNS THAT I NEED A BREAK

 WHAT HELPS ME RECOVER

 PEOPLE I CAN TALK TO

 BREAKS I WILL PROTECT THIS YEAR

If burnout or stress feels hard to manage, seeking professional support is also a way of caring for your practice.

 NOTES

Not for now

IDEA OR TO-DO

WHY NOT NOW

REVISIT ON

Someday, maybe



Professional dreams, courses, trips, books or projects you want to do someday.

☐

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 THE FIRST ONE I WANT TO BRING CLOSER

 NOTES



MY SOCIAL CAPITAL





Professional relationships are built too

Your professional network is part of your practice: it helps you answer questions, refer well, learn from others and serve your community better. Like any system, it works when you tend to it consistently and ethically.

Get to know

- My network categories
- Contact cards
- People I want to meet

Refer ethically

- My referral network
- My referral list

Show up

- Event planner
- Business card follow-up

Share

- Content idea bank

The relationships you tend today are the doors that open tomorrow.



My network categories

Where is your network strong, and where does it need to grow? Write down how many active relationships you have in each category and whom you want to add.

CATEGORY	ACTIVE	WHOM I WANT TO ADD
Immigration colleagues		
Attorneys in other areas		
Community organizations		
Interpreters and translators		
Mentors		
Professional associations		
Consulates and offices		
Press and media		
Academics and educators		
Trusted vendors		
💡 THE CATEGORY I WILL STRENGTHEN THIS YEAR, AND HOW		
✍️ NOTES		

Contact cards

 NAME

 ORGANIZATION AND TITLE

 CONTACT

 WHERE WE MET

 SHARED INTERESTS AND HOW WE CAN HELP EACH OTHER

 NEXT FOLLOW-UP

 NAME

 ORGANIZATION AND TITLE

 CONTACT

 WHERE WE MET

 SHARED INTERESTS AND HOW WE CAN HELP EACH OTHER

 NEXT FOLLOW-UP

 NOTES

 NAME	 ORGANIZATION AND TITLE
 CONTACT	 WHERE WE MET
 SHARED INTERESTS AND HOW WE CAN HELP EACH OTHER	
 NEXT FOLLOW-UP	

Contact cards

 NAME

 ORGANIZATION AND TITLE

 CONTACT

 WHERE WE MET

 SHARED INTERESTS AND HOW WE CAN HELP EACH OTHER

 NEXT FOLLOW-UP

 NAME

 ORGANIZATION AND TITLE

 CONTACT

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 NOTES

Contact cards

 NAME

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 WHERE WE MET

 SHARED INTERESTS AND HOW WE CAN HELP EACH OTHER

 NEXT FOLLOW-UP

 NAME

 ORGANIZATION AND TITLE

 CONTACT

 WHERE WE MET

 SHARED INTERESTS AND HOW WE CAN HELP EACH OTHER

 NEXT FOLLOW-UP

 NOTES

People I want to meet

NAME OR PROFILE	WHY	WHO CAN INTRODUCE US	DONE
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

My referral network

Before you refer, verify. Confirm that the person or organization is authorized to provide the service your client needs (current license, accreditation or recognition, as applicable). Never refer to someone who cannot provide legal services.

- ☐ I verified the license, accreditation or recognition
- ☐ I know the types of cases they accept
- ☐ I know how they prefer to receive referrals
- ☐ I explained to the client that the decision to hire is theirs
- ☐ I documented the referral in the file
- ☐ I reviewed the ethics rules on referrals and fees

MY REFERRAL PROCESS

 NOTES

My referral list

[illegible]

REFERRALS

My referral list · continued

Event planner

EVENT	DATE	LOCATION OR LINK
🔑 WHY I AM GOING		
👤 PEOPLE I WANT TO GREET		
☑ BEFORE THE EVENT		
📝 WHAT I LEARNED		
📅 FOLLOW-UPS I NEED TO DO		
📝 NOTES		

EVENTS

Event planner

EVENT

DATE

LOCATION OR LINK

 WHY I AM GOING

 PEOPLE I WANT TO GREET

 BEFORE THE EVENT

 WHAT I LEARNED

 FOLLOW-UPS I NEED TO DO

 NOTES

Business cards and new contacts

NAME	WHERE	FOLLOW-UP	DONE
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

Content idea bank



RESOURCE LIBRARY



Do not write passwords in this planner. Use a password manager approved by your office.

Your planner continues online



This planner is the beginning of a system that will keep growing with you.

On the author's website you will find information about training, mentoring and resources for immigration professionals. Companion resources for this planner will also be announced there as they become available: printable templates, the complete glossary and updates to official resources.



lcdajessicalperezsalazar.com

 RESOURCES I WOULD LIKE TO FIND

 NOTES

NOTES

Quick notes

Quick notes



NOTES
Quick notes · dotted

This image shows a full page of dot grid paper. The background is white, and it is covered with a regular pattern of small, dark gray dots. The dots are arranged in straight horizontal and vertical rows, creating a grid-like appearance. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the page.



Quick notes · blank



Quick notes · blank



[illegible]



Keep learning.
Keep building.
Keep growing.

Every page you completed this year is evidence of a more organized, more ethical and more mindful practice. Keep this planner: it is the record of how you grew.

 WHAT I WANT TO TELL MY 2028 SELF



Thank You



*for walking through this year
with intention, structure, and purpose.*

*May this planner continue to support
your practice, your growth,
and your professional vision.*

Jessica L. Pérez-Salazar, Esq.

